

Linear Algebra

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Vectors

Exercise 0.1 (Store a data point as one object). A house has a floor area of 120 square meters, 3 bedrooms, and an age of 15 years.

1. Write these three numbers as a single vertical list $\tilde{x}$, in the order given, and call its entries x_1 , x_2 and x_3 . What is x_2 ?
2. Does the list $(3, 120, 15)$ describe the same house?

Solution

Solution 0.1.

1. Stacking the three numbers in order gives

$$\tilde{x} = \begin{bmatrix} 120 \\ 3 \\ 15 \end{bmatrix},$$

so $x_2 = 3$, the number of bedrooms.

2. No. The list $(3, 120, 15)$ would describe a house with 3 square meters of floor area and 120 bedrooms. An entry's position says what it measures, so the order of the entries matters.

Definition 0.1 (Column vector). A **column vector** of length p is an ordered list of p numbers, written vertically:

$$\tilde{x} = \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \\ \vdots \\ x_p \end{bmatrix}$$

Remark 0.1 (Vectors are columns by default). In these notes, as in most statistics textbooks, a vector is a column vector unless stated otherwise. A vector written inline as a list in parentheses is still a column vector: for example, $\tilde{x} = (2, -1, 5)$ means

$$\tilde{x} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ -1 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Definition 0.2 (The set $\mathbb{R}^p$). For a positive integer p , $\mathbb{R}^p$ is the set of all **column vectors** of length p whose entries are real numbers.

Remark 0.2 (Reading $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^p$). Writing $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^p$ says, in one symbol, that $\tilde{x}$ is a column vector with p real entries. For example, $(1, -2, 0.5) \in \mathbb{R}^3$. The vector $(1, 2)$ is not in $\mathbb{R}^3$, because it has only 2 entries; it is in $\mathbb{R}^2$. In Exercise [0.1](#), $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^3$.

Definition 0.3 (Transpose). The **transpose** of a column vector $\tilde{x}$ is the row vector with the same sequence of entries, written horizontally:

$$\tilde{x}^\top \equiv \tilde{x}' \equiv [x_1, x_2, \dots, x_p]$$

Example 0.1 (Transposing a column vector). The transpose of the column vector with entries 2, -1, 5 is the row vector with the same entries:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ -1 \\ 5 \end{bmatrix}^\top = [2, -1, 5].$$

Definition 0.4 (Vector addition). The **sum** of two column vectors $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{y}$ of the same length p is the column vector $\tilde{x} + \tilde{y}$ of length p obtained by adding entry by entry:

$$(\tilde{x} + \tilde{y})_i \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} x_i + y_i, \quad i = 1, \dots, p$$

Example 0.2 (Adding two vectors).

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 5 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1+4 \\ 2+5 \\ 3+6 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 5 \\ 7 \\ 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

Definition 0.5 (Dot product). For any two real-valued vectors $\tilde{x} = (x_1, \dots, x_p)$ and $\tilde{y} = (y_1, \dots, y_p)$ of the same length p , the **dot product** of $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{y}$ is:

$$\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y} = \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{y} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \sum_{i=1}^p x_i y_i \quad (1)$$

See also the definitions in:

- Dobson and Barnett (2018), Section 1.3 (equation 1.1, page 7)
- Kaplan (2022), chapter on vectors
- [wikipedia](#)

The dot product has a different generalization for two matrices; see [wikipedia](#) for more.

Example 0.3 (A dot product). For $\tilde{x} = (1, 2, 3)$ and $\tilde{y} = (4, 5, 6)$:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y} &= 1 \cdot 4 + 2 \cdot 5 + 3 \cdot 6 && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\ &= 4 + 10 + 18 && \text{(multiply)} \\ &= 32 && \text{(add)} \end{aligned}$$

Definition 0.6 (Linear combination). A **linear combination** of the numbers $a_1, \dots, a_k$ with **coefficients** $c_1, \dots, c_k$ is the weighted sum

$$c_1 a_1 + \dots + c_k a_k = \sum_{i=1}^k c_i a_i$$

A linear combination of vectors $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k$ of the same length is defined entry by entry: entry j of $\sum_{i=1}^k c_i \tilde{v}_i$ is the linear combination of the j th entries of $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k$ with the same coefficients. For example, the linear combination of $(1, 0)^\top$ and $(0, 1)^\top$ with coefficients 2 and 3 is $(2 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot 0, 2 \cdot 0 + 3 \cdot 1)^\top = (2, 3)^\top$.

Remark 0.3 (The dot product is a linear combination). The dot product $\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y}$ is a linear combination (Definition 0.6) of the entries of $\tilde{y}$, with coefficients $x_1, \dots, x_p$. In Example 0.3,

$\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y} = 1 \cdot 4 + 2 \cdot 5 + 3 \cdot 6$ is the linear combination of 4, 5, and 6 with coefficients 1, 2, and 3.

The dot product is also the standard *inner product* on $\mathbb{R}^p$; “inner product” is the general notion, of which the dot product is one example.

Theorem 0.1 (Dot product is symmetric). *The dot product is symmetric:*

$$\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y} = \tilde{y} \cdot \tilde{x}$$

i Proof

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y} &= \sum_{i=1}^p x_i y_i && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^p y_i x_i && \text{(products of numbers are symmetric)} \\ &= \tilde{y} \cdot \tilde{x} && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \end{aligned}$$

□

Special vectors

Definition 0.7 (Zero vector). The **zero vector** $\tilde{0}$ of length p has all entries equal to zero:

$$\tilde{0} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Remark 0.4 (The zero vector is the additive identity). Adding the zero vector to a vector leaves it unchanged (Definition 0.4): $\tilde{x} + \tilde{0} = \tilde{x}$ for any vector $\tilde{x}$ of the same length. For example, $(2, -1) + (0, 0) = (2 + 0, -1 + 0) = (2, -1)$.

Definition 0.8 (Ones vector). The **ones vector** $\tilde{1}$ of length p has all entries equal to one:

$$\tilde{\mathbf{1}} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \\ \vdots \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Remark 0.5 (The ones vector sums the entries). The dot product (Definition 0.5) of $\tilde{\mathbf{1}}$ with $\tilde{x}$ is the sum of the entries of $\tilde{x}$: $\tilde{\mathbf{1}} \cdot \tilde{x} = \sum_{i=1}^p 1 \cdot x_i = \sum_{i=1}^p x_i$. For example, for $\tilde{x} = (2, -1, 5)$, $\tilde{\mathbf{1}} \cdot \tilde{x} = 2 + (-1) + 5 = 6$, and dividing by the length $p = 3$ gives the mean of the entries, $6/3 = 2$.

Definition 0.9 (Indicator vector / standard basis vector). The j -th **indicator vector** (or *standard basis vector*) $\tilde{e}_j$ of length p has a 1 in position j and 0s elsewhere:

$$(\tilde{e}_j)_i = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 & \text{if } i \neq j \end{cases} \quad \tilde{e}_j = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \leftarrow \text{position } j$$

Remark 0.6 (Indicator vectors build every vector). For $p = 3$, the indicator vectors are $\tilde{e}_1 = (1, 0, 0)$, $\tilde{e}_2 = (0, 1, 0)$, and $\tilde{e}_3 = (0, 0, 1)$. Every vector of length 3 is a weighted sum $c_1\tilde{e}_1 + c_2\tilde{e}_2 + c_3\tilde{e}_3$ of them, with weights equal to its entries; for example, $(2, -1, 5) = 2\tilde{e}_1 - 1\tilde{e}_2 + 5\tilde{e}_3$. No other weights work: entry j of $c_1\tilde{e}_1 + c_2\tilde{e}_2 + c_3\tilde{e}_3$ is c_j , so each weight c_j must equal entry j of the vector.

Theorem 0.2 (Indicator vectors select entries). *For any vector $\tilde{x}$ of length p and any $j \in \{1, \dots, p\}$:*

$$\tilde{e}_j \cdot \tilde{x} = x_j$$

i Proof

Proof. Writing the dot product componentwise:

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{e}_j \cdot \tilde{x} &= \sum_{i=1}^p (\tilde{e}_j)_i x_i && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^p \begin{cases} 1 \cdot x_i & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 \cdot x_i & \text{if } i \neq j \end{cases} && \text{(definition of } \tilde{e}_j \text{)} \\
&= x_j && \text{(only the } i = j \text{ term is nonzero)}
\end{aligned}$$

□

Orthogonality

Definition 0.10 (Orthogonal vectors). Two vectors $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{y}$ of the same length are **orthogonal** (written $\tilde{x} \perp \tilde{y}$) if their dot product (Definition 0.5) is zero:

$$\tilde{x} \perp \tilde{y} \iff \tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{y} = 0$$

Remark 0.7 (Orthogonal means perpendicular). Orthogonality extends the geometric idea of perpendicular lines to vectors with any number of entries. In the plane, $(1, 2)$ and $(-2, 1)$ are perpendicular, and their dot product is $1 \cdot (-2) + 2 \cdot 1 = 0$. The same test works in three dimensions, where pictures are harder to draw: $(1, 1, 0) \cdot (1, -1, 5) = 1 - 1 + 0 = 0$, so $(1, 1, 0) \perp (1, -1, 5)$.

Definition 0.11 (Euclidean norm). The **Euclidean norm** (or *length*, also called the L_2 norm and written $\|\tilde{x}\|_2$) of a vector $\tilde{x}$ of length p is

$$\|\tilde{x}\| \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \sqrt{\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{x}} = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^p x_i^2} \quad (2)$$

Example 0.4 (The length of a vector). For $\tilde{x} = (3, 4)$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\|\tilde{x}\| &= \sqrt{3^2 + 4^2} && \text{(definition of the norm)} \\
&= \sqrt{25} && \text{(square and add)} \\
&= 5
\end{aligned}$$

The vector $(0.6, 0.8)$ has norm $\sqrt{0.36 + 0.64} = 1$.

Exercise 0.2 (How far apart are two points?). Let $\tilde{x} = (1, 2)$ and $\tilde{y} = (4, 6)$.

1. Compute the vector $\tilde{x} - \tilde{y}$.
2. Compute the length of $\tilde{x} - \tilde{y}$, using the [Euclidean norm](#).
3. Is the result the same if you compute the length of $\tilde{y} - \tilde{x}$ instead?

Solution

Solution 0.2.

1. $\tilde{x} - \tilde{y} = (1 - 4, 2 - 6) = (-3, -4)$.
2. $\|\tilde{x} - \tilde{y}\| = \sqrt{(-3)^2 + (-4)^2} = \sqrt{25} = 5$.
3. $\tilde{y} - \tilde{x} = (3, 4)$, and $\|\tilde{y} - \tilde{x}\| = \sqrt{3^2 + 4^2} = 5$. Yes, the result is the same.

Definition 0.12 (Euclidean distance). The **Euclidean distance** between two vectors $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{y}$ of length p is the [Euclidean norm](#) of their difference:

$$d(\tilde{x}, \tilde{y}) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \|\tilde{x} - \tilde{y}\| = \sqrt{\sum_{i=1}^p (x_i - y_i)^2} \quad (3)$$

Remark 0.8 (Distance from the origin). The distance from the origin $\tilde{0}$ to a vector $\tilde{x}$ is the norm of $\tilde{x}$: $d(\tilde{x}, \tilde{0}) = \|\tilde{x} - \tilde{0}\| = \|\tilde{x}\|$ (Goodfellow et al. 2016, 39).

For example, the distance from $\tilde{0}$ to $(3, 4)$ is $\|(3, 4)\| = 5$, as in [Example 0.4](#).

Definition 0.13 (Orthonormal vectors). A set of vectors $\{\tilde{x}_1, \tilde{x}_2, \dots, \tilde{x}_k\}$ is **orthonormal** if the vectors are mutually orthogonal ([Definition 0.10](#)) and each has norm 1 ([Definition 0.11](#)), that is, unit length:

$$\tilde{x}_i \cdot \tilde{x}_j = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 & \text{if } i \neq j \end{cases}$$

Example 0.5 (Indicator vectors are orthonormal). The indicator vectors $\tilde{e}_1, \tilde{e}_2, \dots, \tilde{e}_p$ ([Definition 0.9](#)) form an orthonormal set. By [Theorem 0.2](#), $\tilde{e}_i \cdot \tilde{e}_j$ is entry i of $\tilde{e}_j$, which is 1 if $i = j$ and 0 if $i \neq j$. For $p = 2$: $\tilde{e}_1 \cdot \tilde{e}_1 = 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 = 1$, $\tilde{e}_2 \cdot \tilde{e}_2 = 0 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 = 1$, and $\tilde{e}_1 \cdot \tilde{e}_2 = 1 \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot 1 = 0$.

Exercise 0.3 (Compute an inner product and a norm). Let

$$\tilde{a} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ -1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \tilde{b} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 4 \\ -2 \end{bmatrix}$$

Compute $\tilde{a}^\top \tilde{b}$ and $\|\tilde{a}\|_2$.

Solution

Solution 0.3. Multiply entry by entry and add:

$$\tilde{a}^\top \tilde{b} = (3)(0) + (-1)(4) + (2)(-2) = 0 - 4 - 4 = -8$$

For the norm, take the inner product of $\tilde{a}$ with itself first:

$$\tilde{a}^\top \tilde{a} = 3^2 + (-1)^2 + 2^2 = 9 + 1 + 4 = 14$$

so

$$\|\tilde{a}\|_2 = \sqrt{14} \approx 3.742$$

The inner product came out negative while the norm cannot: a norm is a square root of a sum of squares, so it is never below zero.

Python has both operations built in, and R builds them from `sum`.

```
import numpy as np

a = np.array([3.0, -1.0, 2.0])
b = np.array([0.0, 4.0, -2.0])

print(a @ b, round(float(np.linalg.norm(a)), 3))
```

```
a <- c(3, -1, 2)
b <- c(0, 4, -2)

print(c(sum(a * b), round(sqrt(sum(a^2)), 3)))
#> [1] -8.000 3.742
```

Both print -8 and 3.742 .

💡 Video lecture

Hutchinson's [Linear Function Basics](#) (24 min) covers dot products and the Euclidean norm, and goes on to hyperplanes and level sets (Hutchinson, n.d.). The login for the video site is posted [on Canvas](#).

Matrices

Definition 0.14 (Matrix). A **matrix** of dimensions $m \times n$ is a rectangular array of $m \cdot n$ numbers, arranged in m rows and n columns:

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} a_{11} & a_{12} & \cdots & a_{1n} \\ a_{21} & a_{22} & \cdots & a_{2n} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ a_{m1} & a_{m2} & \cdots & a_{mn} \end{bmatrix}$$

Remark 0.9 (Matrix entries, and vectors as matrices). The entry in row i and column j of $\mathbf{A}$ is written a_{ij} or $(\mathbf{A})_{ij}$. For example, for the 2×3 matrix

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \end{bmatrix},$$

$a_{12} = 2$ and $a_{23} = 6$.

A column vector of length p is a $p \times 1$ matrix, and a row vector of length p is a $1 \times p$ matrix. For example, the column vector $(7, 8)$ is a 2×1 matrix, and the row vector $[7, 8]$ is a 1×2 matrix.

Definition 0.15 (Tensor). A **tensor** of order $k \geq 1$ is an array of numbers with k indices,

$$\mathcal{A} = (a_{i_1 i_2 \dots i_k}), \quad i_1 = 1, \dots, n_1, \dots, i_k = 1, \dots, n_k,$$

and its dimensions are $n_1 \times n_2 \times \cdots \times n_k$.

Example 0.6 (Vectors, matrices and images as tensors). A vector of length p is a tensor of order 1, and an $m \times n$ [matrix](#) is a tensor of order 2. A 28×28 grayscale image is a matrix: the entry a_{ij} is the brightness of the pixel in row i and column j . A 28×28 color image stores three numbers per pixel (red, green, blue), so it is an order-3 tensor with dimensions $28 \times 28 \times 3$, and a_{ijc} is the value of color channel c at the pixel in row i and column j . It has $28 \cdot 28 \cdot 3 = 2352$ entries.

Matrix transpose

Definition 0.16 (Matrix transpose). The **transpose** of an $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is the $n \times m$ matrix $\mathbf{A}^\top$ obtained by swapping the rows and columns of $\mathbf{A}$:

$$(\mathbf{A}^\top)_{ij} = a_{ji}$$

Matrix addition

Definition 0.17 (Zero matrix). The $m \times n$ **zero matrix** $\mathbf{0}_{m \times n}$ (or $\mathbf{0}$ when dimensions are clear from context) has all entries equal to zero:

$$\mathbf{0}_{m \times n} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Definition 0.18 (Matrix addition). Two matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ of the same dimensions $m \times n$ can be added element-wise; their **matrix sum** is:

$$(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})_{ij} = a_{ij} + b_{ij}$$

Theorem 0.3 (Matrix addition is commutative). For $m \times n$ matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$:

$$\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B} = \mathbf{B} + \mathbf{A}$$

Theorem 0.4 (Matrix addition is associative). For $m \times n$ matrices $\mathbf{A}$, $\mathbf{B}$, and $\mathbf{C}$:

$$(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B}) + \mathbf{C} = \mathbf{A} + (\mathbf{B} + \mathbf{C})$$

Theorem 0.5 (Zero matrix is the additive identity). For an $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$:

$$\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{0}_{m \times n} = \mathbf{A}$$

Theorem 0.6 (Additive inverse). For any $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$, the $m \times n$ matrix $-\mathbf{A}$ (defined by $(-\mathbf{A})_{ij} = -a_{ij}$) satisfies:

$$\mathbf{A} + (-\mathbf{A}) = \mathbf{0}_{m \times n}$$

Scalar multiplication

Definition 0.19 (Scalar multiplication). The **scalar multiple** of a matrix $\mathbf{A}$ by a scalar c is:

$$(c\mathbf{A})_{ij} = c \cdot a_{ij}$$

Matrix multiplication

Definition 0.20 (Matrix multiplication). The **product** of an $m \times k$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ and a $k \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{B}$ is the $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{AB}$ with entries:

$$c_{ij} = \sum_{s=1}^k a_{is} b_{sj}$$

Remark 0.10 (Matrix multiplication is not commutative). When $\mathbf{AB}$ and $\mathbf{BA}$ are both defined, they are usually different. For example, with

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix},$$

$$\mathbf{AB} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \neq \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} = \mathbf{BA}.$$

Example 0.7 (Dot product as matrix multiplication). The dot product of two column vectors $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{\beta}$ can be written as a matrix product of the row vector $\tilde{x}^\top$ with the column vector $\tilde{\beta}$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{x} \cdot \tilde{\beta} &= \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{\beta} \\
&= [x_1, x_2, \dots, x_p] \begin{bmatrix} \beta_1 \\ \beta_2 \\ \vdots \\ \beta_p \end{bmatrix} \\
&= x_1\beta_1 + x_2\beta_2 + \dots + x_p\beta_p
\end{aligned}$$

Theorem 0.7 (Matrix multiplication is associative). *For an $m \times k$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$, a $k \times l$ matrix $\mathbf{B}$, and an $l \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{C}$:*

$$\underbrace{(\mathbf{AB})\mathbf{C}}_{m \times n} = \underbrace{\mathbf{A}(\mathbf{BC})}_{m \times n}$$

i Proof

Proof. Entry (i, j) of each side, from Definition 0.20:

$$\begin{aligned}
[(\mathbf{AB})\mathbf{C}]_{ij} &= \sum_{t=1}^l (\mathbf{AB})_{it} c_{tj} && \text{(definition of } (\mathbf{AB})\mathbf{C} \text{)} \\
&= \sum_{t=1}^l \left(\sum_{s=1}^k a_{is} b_{st} \right) c_{tj} && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{AB} \text{)} \\
&= \sum_{s=1}^k a_{is} \left(\sum_{t=1}^l b_{st} c_{tj} \right) && \text{(distribute and swap the finite sums)} \\
&= \sum_{s=1}^k a_{is} (\mathbf{BC})_{sj} && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{BC} \text{)} \\
&= [\mathbf{A}(\mathbf{BC})]_{ij} && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{A}(\mathbf{BC}) \text{)}
\end{aligned}$$

□

Theorem 0.8 (Matrix multiplication is distributive over addition). *For an $m \times k$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ and $k \times n$ matrices $\mathbf{B}$ and $\mathbf{C}$:*

$$\mathbf{A}(\mathbf{B} + \mathbf{C}) = \mathbf{AB} + \mathbf{AC}$$

For $m \times k$ matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ and a $k \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{C}$:

$$(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})\mathbf{C} = \mathbf{AC} + \mathbf{BC}$$

Exercise 0.4 (Which of these products are defined?). Let $\mathbf{A}$ be 4×3 , let $\mathbf{B}$ be 3×2 , and let $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^3$. For each expression, say whether it is defined, and if so give the shape of the result:

1. $\mathbf{AB}$
2. $\mathbf{BA}$
3. $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$
4. $\tilde{x}^\top \tilde{x}$
5. $\tilde{x}\tilde{x}^\top$

Solution

Solution 0.4. A vector in $\mathbb{R}^3$ is a 3×1 matrix, so the same rule settles every case.

1. $\mathbf{AB}$: $(4 \times 3)(3 \times 2)$. The inner pair is 3 and 3, so it is defined, and the result is 4×2 .
2. $\mathbf{BA}$: $(3 \times 2)(4 \times 3)$. The inner pair is 2 and 4, which do not match, so it is **not defined**. Matrix multiplication is not commutative, and this is the blunt form of that: swapping the order can leave an expression that means nothing.
3. $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$: $(4 \times 3)(3 \times 1)$, defined, result 4×1 — a vector in $\mathbb{R}^4$.
4. $\tilde{x}^\top \tilde{x}$: $(1 \times 3)(3 \times 1)$, defined, result 1×1 — a single number. The product is the inner product of Equation 1.
5. $\tilde{x}\tilde{x}^\top$: $(3 \times 1)(1 \times 3)$, defined, result 3×3 — a matrix.

The last two use the same two vectors and differ only in order, and they return objects of different kinds. Reading a transpose as decoration rather than as a shape change is the commonest way to lose track of an expression.

Matrix-vector multiplication

Definition 0.21 (Matrix-vector multiplication). The **matrix-vector product** of an $m \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ and a $p \times 1$ column vector $\tilde{x}$ is the $m \times 1$ column vector $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$ with entries:

$$(\mathbf{A}\tilde{x})_i = \sum_{j=1}^p a_{ij} x_j$$

Remark 0.11 (Each entry is a dot product). Matrix-vector multiplication extends the dot product (Definition 0.5): entry i of $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$ is the dot product of row i of $\mathbf{A}$ with $\tilde{x}$. For example,

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot (-1) \\ 3 \cdot 1 + 4 \cdot (-1) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Linear and affine maps

Definition 0.22 (Linear map). A function $f : \mathbb{R}^p \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ is a **linear map** (or linear transformation) if it preserves vector addition and scalar multiplication: for all $\tilde{x}, \tilde{y} \in \mathbb{R}^p$ and $c \in \mathbb{R}$,

1. $f(\tilde{x} + \tilde{y}) = f(\tilde{x}) + f(\tilde{y})$
2. $f(c\tilde{x}) = cf(\tilde{x})$

Every such function can be represented as multiplication by an $m \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$:

$$f(\tilde{x}) = \mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$$

A linear map always maps the zero vector to the zero vector: $f(\tilde{0}) = \tilde{0}$.

Definition 0.23 (Affine transformation). An **affine transformation** is a function $f : \mathbb{R}^p \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$ composed of a linear map followed by a translation:

$$f(\tilde{x}) = \mathbf{A}\tilde{x} + \tilde{b}, \quad \mathbf{A} \in \mathbb{R}^{m \times p}, \quad \tilde{b} \in \mathbb{R}^m$$

For a scalar-valued function ($m = 1$), this is an inner product plus an offset:

$$f(\tilde{x}) = \tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x} + b, \quad \tilde{w} \in \mathbb{R}^p, \quad b \in \mathbb{R} \quad (4)$$

When $\tilde{b} \neq \tilde{0}$ (or $b \neq 0$), an affine transformation does not send $\tilde{0}$ to $\tilde{0}$, so it is not strictly linear. In machine learning and statistics, functions of this form are commonly referred to as **linear models** or linear functions, with $\tilde{b}$ (or b) called the **bias** or **intercept**.

Definition 0.24 (Hyperplane). A **hyperplane** in $\mathbb{R}^p$ is an affine subspace of dimension $p - 1$. It is defined as the set of points $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^p$ satisfying:

$$\tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x} + b = 0$$

where $\tilde{w} \in \mathbb{R}^p \setminus \{\tilde{0}\}$ is the normal vector orthogonal to the hyperplane and $b \in \mathbb{R}$ is the offset. When $b = 0$, the hyperplane passes through the origin and forms a $(p - 1)$ -dimensional linear subspace.

Geometrically:

- In $\mathbb{R}^2$ ($p = 2$), a hyperplane is a 1-dimensional line: $w_1x_1 + w_2x_2 + b = 0$.
- In $\mathbb{R}^3$ ($p = 3$), a hyperplane is a 2-dimensional plane.
- A hyperplane divides the space $\mathbb{R}^p$ into two open **half-spaces**: $\{\tilde{x} : \tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x} + b > 0\}$ and $\{\tilde{x} : \tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x} + b < 0\}$.

The course website's version of this page has an interactive plot here.

Exercise 0.5 (Write a rule in matrix form). A clinic scores a patient's risk from three measurements.

symbol	meaning	units
x_1	age	years
x_2	systolic blood pressure	mmHg
x_3	body mass index	kg/m ²

The rule in use is

$$\text{score} = 0.4x_1 + 0.2x_2 + 1.5x_3 - 30$$

Write this rule in the form of Equation 4, naming $\tilde{w}$, b and p explicitly, and give the score for a patient aged 50 with blood pressure 130 and BMI 28.

Solution

Solution 0.5. Read the coefficients straight off the rule. There are three inputs, so $p = 3$:

$$\tilde{w} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.4 \\ 0.2 \\ 1.5 \end{bmatrix}, \quad b = -30$$

and the rule is $f(\tilde{x}) = \tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x} + b$. For the patient,

$$\tilde{x} = \begin{bmatrix} 50 \\ 130 \\ 28 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$\tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x} = (0.4)(50) + (0.2)(130) + (1.5)(28) = 20 + 26 + 42 = 88$$

$$f(\tilde{x}) = 88 - 30 = 58$$

Two things are worth noticing. The coefficients are not comparable as they stand: 1.5 is the largest number but BMI is measured on the smallest scale, so the weight on a feature

says nothing on its own about how much that feature matters. And $b = -30$ is doing real work — without it the score would be 88, which is a different clinical claim entirely.

Exercise 0.6 (Which of these are linear in $\tilde{w}$?). Each of the five expressions is a function of the weights $\tilde{w} \in \mathbb{R}^p$, with the data $\tilde{x}$ and y held fixed. Say which ones have the form Equation 4 — an inner product plus an offset — and which do not.

1. $\tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x}$
2. $\tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x} - y$
3. $(\tilde{w}^\top \tilde{x} - y)^2$
4. $\|\tilde{w}\|_2^2$
5. $w_1 x_1 + 3$

Solution

Solution 0.6.

1. **Linear.** It is Equation 4 with $b = 0$.
2. **Linear.** Still an inner product plus an offset; here the offset is $b = -y$, which is a constant because y is held fixed.
3. **Not linear.** Squaring is not an inner product plus an offset. This expression is the squared error of one observation, and its curvature in $\tilde{w}$ is exactly why fitting a model is an optimization problem rather than a lookup.
4. **Not linear.** By Equation 2 this is $\tilde{w}^\top \tilde{w}$, which has $\tilde{w}$ in both slots at once. Hold either slot fixed and it is linear in the other; as a function of the single variable $\tilde{w}$ it is quadratic.
5. **Linear.** It is Equation 4 with coefficient vector $\tilde{a} = (x_1, 0, \dots, 0)^\top$ and $b = 3$. The data $\tilde{x}$ is untouched — $\tilde{a}$ is a new vector built from its first entry.

Items 1, 2 and 5 are linear and items 3 and 4 are not, which is the split that matters: a *model* can be linear in its weights while the *quantity we minimize* is not. Squared error and the norm penalty are both curved in $\tilde{w}$, and that curvature is what makes fitting an optimization problem at all: there is always a downhill direction to follow. Curvature alone does not promise a *single* answer. The squared error of one observation is completely flat along a whole line of weight vectors, every one of which fits that observation exactly, and pinning down one of them is part of what the norm penalty is added for in week 3.

Transposes of sums and products

Theorem 0.9 (Transpose of a sum). *For $m \times n$ matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$:*

$$(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})^\top = \mathbf{A}^\top + \mathbf{B}^\top$$

In particular, for column vectors $\tilde{x}$ and $\tilde{y}$ of the same length:

$$(\tilde{x} + \tilde{y})^\top = \tilde{x}^\top + \tilde{y}^\top$$

Proof

Proof. Entry (i, j) of each side:

$$\begin{aligned} [(\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})^\top]_{ij} &= (\mathbf{A} + \mathbf{B})_{ji} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\ &= a_{ji} + b_{ji} && \text{(definition of matrix addition)} \\ &= (\mathbf{A}^\top)_{ij} + (\mathbf{B}^\top)_{ij} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\ &= [\mathbf{A}^\top + \mathbf{B}^\top]_{ij} && \text{(definition of matrix addition)} \end{aligned}$$

□

Theorem 0.10 (Transpose of a product). *For an $m \times k$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ and a $k \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{B}$:*

$$\underbrace{(\mathbf{AB})^\top}_{n \times m} = \underbrace{\mathbf{B}^\top}_{n \times k} \underbrace{\mathbf{A}^\top}_{k \times m}$$

Proof

Proof. Entry (i, j) of each side:

$$\begin{aligned} [(\mathbf{AB})^\top]_{ij} &= (\mathbf{AB})_{ji} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\ &= \sum_{s=1}^k a_{js} b_{si} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\ &= \sum_{s=1}^k (\mathbf{B}^\top)_{is} (\mathbf{A}^\top)_{sj} && \text{(definition of the transpose; reorder each product)} \\ &= [\mathbf{B}^\top \mathbf{A}^\top]_{ij} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \end{aligned}$$

□

Remark 0.12 (The order of the factors reverses). Transposing a product reverses the order of the factors. Keeping the original order usually gives an undefined product or a different matrix. For example, with $\mathbf{A} = [1, 2]$ (1×2) and $\mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix}$ (2×1), $\mathbf{AB} = 1 \cdot 3 + 2 \cdot 4 = 11$, so $(\mathbf{AB})^\top = 11$, and

$$\mathbf{B}^\top \mathbf{A}^\top = [3, 4] \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} = 11, \quad \mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{B}^\top = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} [3, 4] = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 4 \\ 6 & 8 \end{bmatrix}.$$

If instead $\mathbf{A}$ is 2×3 and $\mathbf{B}$ is 3×1 , then $\mathbf{B}^\top \mathbf{A}^\top$ is a $(1 \times 3)(3 \times 2)$ product, but $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{B}^\top$ is a $(3 \times 2)(1 \times 3)$ product, which is undefined.

Rank

Definition 0.25 (Linearly independent vectors). Vectors $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k$ of the same length p are **linearly independent** if the only numbers $c_1, \dots, c_k$ with

$$c_1 \tilde{v}_1 + \dots + c_k \tilde{v}_k = \tilde{0}$$

are $c_1 = \dots = c_k = 0$.

Example 0.8 (Independent and dependent pairs of vectors).

- $\tilde{v}_1 = (1, 0)$ and $\tilde{v}_2 = (1, 1)$ are linearly independent: $c_1 \tilde{v}_1 + c_2 \tilde{v}_2 = (c_1 + c_2, c_2)$, which is $\tilde{0}$ only if $c_2 = 0$ and then $c_1 = 0$.
- $\tilde{v}_1 = (1, 2)$ and $\tilde{v}_2 = (2, 4)$ are not: $2\tilde{v}_1 - \tilde{v}_2 = \tilde{0}$.

Definition 0.26 (Rank). The **rank** of a matrix $\mathbf{A}$, written $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A})$, is the largest number of columns of $\mathbf{A}$ that are linearly independent (Definition 0.25).

Example 0.9 (The rank of two 3×2 matrices). The matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$ has rank 2: if

$c_1(1, 1, 1) + c_2(1, 2, 3) = \tilde{0}$, then subtracting the first entry from the second gives $c_2 = 0$, and then $c_1 = 0$.

The matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$ has rank 1: its second column is twice its first, so the two columns are not linearly independent, but the first column on its own is.

Definition 0.27 (Full column rank). An $n \times p$ matrix has **full column rank** if its rank (Definition 0.26) is p , so that all of its columns are linearly independent.

Remark 0.13 (Full column rank needs at least as many rows as columns). In Example 0.9, the first matrix has full column rank: its rank is 2, and it has 2 columns. The second does not, because its rank is 1.

An $n \times p$ matrix can have full column rank only when $p \leq n$, because more than n vectors of length n are never linearly independent. For example, the 2×3 matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ has 3 columns of length 2, and $1 \cdot (1, 0) + 1 \cdot (0, 1) - 1 \cdot (1, 1) = \tilde{0}$, with coefficients that are not all zero. So its 3 columns are not linearly independent, and its rank is less than 3.

Subspaces

This section is adapted from Zhou (2024b), used under the MIT License.

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Definition 0.28 (Subspace). A set $\mathcal{S}$ of vectors in $\mathbb{R}^p$ is a **subspace** of $\mathbb{R}^p$ if it is not empty and it is closed under vector addition and scalar multiplication:

1. if $\tilde{u} \in \mathcal{S}$ and $\tilde{v} \in \mathcal{S}$, then $\tilde{u} + \tilde{v} \in \mathcal{S}$;
2. if $\tilde{u} \in \mathcal{S}$ and $c \in \mathbb{R}$, then $c\tilde{u} \in \mathcal{S}$.

A subspace is also called a **linear subspace**, a **vector space**, or a **linear space**.

Example 0.10 (A line through the origin is a subspace). Let $\mathcal{S} = \{c(1, 2) : c \in \mathbb{R}\}$, the line in $\mathbb{R}^2$ through $(0, 0)$ and $(1, 2)$.

- **Addition:** $a(1, 2) + b(1, 2) = (a + b)(1, 2)$, which is in $\mathcal{S}$.
- **Scalar multiplication:** $c(a(1, 2)) = (ca)(1, 2)$, which is in $\mathcal{S}$.

So $\mathcal{S}$ is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^2$. Two other subspaces of $\mathbb{R}^p$ are the set $\{\tilde{0}\}$ that holds only the zero vector, and $\mathbb{R}^p$ itself.

Example 0.11 (A line that misses the origin is not a subspace). Let $\mathcal{T} = \{(x, 1) : x \in \mathbb{R}\}$, the horizontal line in $\mathbb{R}^2$ at height 1. The vectors $(0, 1)$ and $(2, 1)$ are in $\mathcal{T}$, but their sum $(2, 2)$ is not, because its second entry is 2, not 1. So $\mathcal{T}$ is not closed under addition, and it is not a subspace.

Theorem 0.11 (Every subspace contains the zero vector). *If $\mathcal{S}$ is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^p$ (Definition 0.28), then $\tilde{0} \in \mathcal{S}$.*

i Proof

Proof. A subspace is not empty, so it contains some vector $\tilde{u}$. Closure under scalar multiplication with $c = 0$ puts $0 \cdot \tilde{u}$ in $\mathcal{S}$, and $0 \cdot \tilde{u} = \tilde{0}$. $\square$

Example 0.12 (Using the zero vector to rule out a subspace). The plane $\{(x, y, z) : x + y + z = 1\}$ in $\mathbb{R}^3$ does not contain $\tilde{0} = (0, 0, 0)$, because $0 + 0 + 0 = 0 \neq 1$. So, by Theorem 0.11, it is not a subspace. The line $\mathcal{T}$ in Example 0.11 fails the same test: $(0, 0)$ is not in $\mathcal{T}$, because its second entry is not 1.

Containing $\tilde{0}$ is necessary but not sufficient. The union of the two coordinate axes in $\mathbb{R}^2$, $\{(x, 0) : x \in \mathbb{R}\} \cup \{(0, y) : y \in \mathbb{R}\}$, contains $\tilde{0}$, but $(1, 0) + (0, 1) = (1, 1)$ lies on neither axis, so the union is not closed under addition and is not a subspace.

Definition 0.29 (Span). The **span** of vectors $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k \in \mathbb{R}^p$ is the set of all their linear combinations:

$$\text{span}\{\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k\} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \{c_1\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + c_k\tilde{v}_k : c_1, \dots, c_k \in \mathbb{R}\}.$$

The vectors $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k$ **span** a set $\mathcal{S}$ if their span equals $\mathcal{S}$.

By convention, the span of the empty list ($k = 0$) is $\{\tilde{0}\}$, and the empty list counts as

linearly independent (Definition 0.25), since it has no coefficients that could fail to be zero.

Example 0.13 (Two spans in $\mathbb{R}^3$).

- $\text{span}\{(1, 0, 0), (0, 1, 0)\}$ is the set of vectors $(c_1, c_2, 0)$, the plane $z = 0$ in $\mathbb{R}^3$.
- $\text{span}\{(1, 2, 3), (2, 4, 6)\}$ is only the line $\{c(1, 2, 3) : c \in \mathbb{R}\}$, because $(2, 4, 6) = 2(1, 2, 3)$, so $c_1(1, 2, 3) + c_2(2, 4, 6) = (c_1 + 2c_2)(1, 2, 3)$. Adding a vector to a list does not always enlarge its span.

Theorem 0.12 (A span is a subspace). *For any vectors $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k \in \mathbb{R}^p$, $\text{span}\{\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k\}$ (Definition 0.29) is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^p$ (Definition 0.28).*

i Proof

Proof. The span is not empty: it contains $0 \cdot \tilde{v}_1 + \dots + 0 \cdot \tilde{v}_k = \tilde{0}$.

Addition. Take two vectors in the span, $\tilde{u} = a_1\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + a_k\tilde{v}_k$ and $\tilde{w} = b_1\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + b_k\tilde{v}_k$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{u} + \tilde{w} &= (a_1\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + a_k\tilde{v}_k) + (b_1\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + b_k\tilde{v}_k) \quad (\text{substitute the two combinations}) \\ &= (a_1 + b_1)\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + (a_k + b_k)\tilde{v}_k \quad (\text{regroup, and distribute each } \tilde{v}_i)\end{aligned}$$

which is a linear combination of $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k$, so it is in the span.

Scalar multiplication. For $c \in \mathbb{R}$,

$$\begin{aligned}c\tilde{u} &= c(a_1\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + a_k\tilde{v}_k) \quad (\text{substitute the combination}) \\ &= (ca_1)\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + (ca_k)\tilde{v}_k \quad (\text{distribute } c \text{ over the sum})\end{aligned}$$

which is again in the span. □

Example 0.14 (The line in Example 0.10 is a span). The line $\mathcal{S} = \{c(1, 2) : c \in \mathbb{R}\}$ in Example 0.10 is $\text{span}\{(1, 2)\}$, so Theorem 0.12 gives a second proof that it is a subspace. Likewise, the plane $z = 0$ in Example 0.13 is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^3$, because it is $\text{span}\{(1, 0, 0), (0, 1, 0)\}$.

Theorem 0.13 (A matrix-vector product combines the columns). *If $\mathbf{A}$ is an $m \times n$ matrix with columns $\tilde{a}_1, \dots, \tilde{a}_n$ and $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, then*

$$\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = x_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + x_n\tilde{a}_n.$$

i Proof

Proof. Compare entry i of the two sides, for each $i = 1, \dots, m$. Entry i of $\tilde{a}_j$ is a_{ij} , so

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{A}\tilde{x})_i &= a_{i1}x_1 + \dots + a_{in}x_n && (\text{@def-matvec-mult}) \\ &= x_1a_{i1} + \dots + x_na_{in} && (\text{multiplication of numbers is commutative}) \\ &= (x_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + x_n\tilde{a}_n)_i && (\text{entry } i \text{ of each } x_j\tilde{a}_j \text{ is } x_ja_{ij}) \end{aligned}$$

□

Example 0.15 (A product as a combination of columns).

$$\begin{aligned} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} &= 1 \cdot \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} + (-1) \cdot \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} && (\text{@thm-matvec-columns}) \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}, && (\text{arithmetic}) \end{aligned}$$

the same answer as computing each entry as a row-times-vector dot product (Remark 0.11).

Theorem 0.14 (A matrix maps a combination to the same combination of images). *If $\mathbf{A}$ is an $m \times n$ matrix, $\tilde{z}_1, \dots, \tilde{z}_k \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and $c_1, \dots, c_k \in \mathbb{R}$, then*

$$\mathbf{A}(c_1\tilde{z}_1 + \dots + c_k\tilde{z}_k) = c_1\mathbf{A}\tilde{z}_1 + \dots + c_k\mathbf{A}\tilde{z}_k.$$

i Proof

Proof. Write z_{ij} for entry j of $\tilde{z}_i$, so entry j of $\sum_i c_i\tilde{z}_i$ is $\sum_i c_iz_{ij}$. Compare entry r of the two sides, for each $r = 1, \dots, m$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\left(\mathbf{A} \sum_{i=1}^k c_i \tilde{z}_i \right)_r &= \sum_{j=1}^n a_{rj} \sum_{i=1}^k c_i z_{ij} \quad (\text{@def-matvec-mult}) \\
&= \sum_{j=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^k a_{rj} c_i z_{ij} \quad (\text{distribute } a_{rj} \text{ over the inner sum}) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^k \sum_{j=1}^n a_{rj} c_i z_{ij} \quad (\text{reorder the finite double sum}) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^k \sum_{j=1}^n c_i a_{rj} z_{ij} \quad (\text{multiplication of numbers is commutative}) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^k c_i \sum_{j=1}^n a_{rj} z_{ij} \quad (\text{factor } c_i \text{ out of the inner sum}) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^k c_i (\mathbf{A} \tilde{z}_i)_r \quad (\text{@def-matvec-mult})
\end{aligned}$$

which is entry r of $\sum_i c_i \mathbf{A} \tilde{z}_i$. □

Example 0.16 (Applying a matrix to a combination). Let $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$, $\tilde{z}_1 = (1, 0)$ and $\tilde{z}_2 = (0, 1)$. Then $\mathbf{A} \tilde{z}_1 = (1, 3)$ and $\mathbf{A} \tilde{z}_2 = (2, 4)$, and for the combination $2\tilde{z}_1 - \tilde{z}_2 = (2, -1)$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{A} (2, -1) &= (1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot (-1), 3 \cdot 2 + 4 \cdot (-1)) \quad (\text{@def-matvec-mult}) \\
&= (0, 2) \quad (\text{arithmetic}) \\
&= 2(1, 3) - (2, 4), \quad (\text{arithmetic})
\end{aligned}$$

which is $2\mathbf{A} \tilde{z}_1 - \mathbf{A} \tilde{z}_2$, as Theorem 0.14 says.

Theorem 0.15 (More than p vectors in $\mathbb{R}^p$ are linearly dependent). *If $k > p$, then any k vectors $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k \in \mathbb{R}^p$ are not linearly independent (Definition 0.25): some numbers $c_1, \dots, c_k$, not all zero, satisfy $c_1 \tilde{v}_1 + \dots + c_k \tilde{v}_k = \tilde{0}_p$.*

i Proof

Proof. Induction on p .

Base case, $p = 1$. Each $\tilde{v}_i$ is a single number v_i , and $k \geq 2$. If $v_1 = 0$, take $c_1 = 1$ and every other $c_i = 0$. Otherwise take $c_1 = v_2$, $c_2 = -v_1$ and every other $c_i = 0$; then $c_2 \neq 0$, and $v_2 v_1 - v_1 v_2 = 0$.

Inductive step. Let $p \geq 2$, assume the theorem holds for vectors in $\mathbb{R}^{p-1}$, and take

$k > p$ vectors in $\mathbb{R}^p$. Write $v_{i,p}$ for the last entry of $\tilde{v}_i$.

Case 1: every $v_{i,p} = 0$. Deleting the last entry gives $k > p - 1$ vectors in $\mathbb{R}^{p-1}$, which by the inductive hypothesis have a combination with coefficients not all zero that equals $\tilde{0}_{p-1}$. The same coefficients combine the original vectors to $\tilde{0}_p$, since every last entry is 0.

Case 2: some $v_{i,p} \neq 0$. Renumber the vectors so that $v_{k,p} \neq 0$, and for $i = 1, \dots, k-1$ let

$$\tilde{w}_i \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \tilde{v}_i - \frac{v_{i,p}}{v_{k,p}} \tilde{v}_k.$$

The last entry of $\tilde{w}_i$ is $v_{i,p} - \frac{v_{i,p}}{v_{k,p}} v_{k,p} = 0$. Deleting that zero last entry gives $k-1 > p-1$ vectors in $\mathbb{R}^{p-1}$, so by the inductive hypothesis there are numbers $c_1, \dots, c_{k-1}$, not all zero, whose combination of the shortened vectors is $\tilde{0}_{p-1}$. Putting the zero last entries back gives $c_1 \tilde{w}_1 + \dots + c_{k-1} \tilde{w}_{k-1} = \tilde{0}_p$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{0}_p &= c_1 \tilde{w}_1 + \dots + c_{k-1} \tilde{w}_{k-1} && \text{(choice of } c_1, \dots, c_{k-1} \text{)} \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} c_i \left(\tilde{v}_i - \frac{v_{i,p}}{v_{k,p}} \tilde{v}_k \right) && \text{(definition of } \tilde{w}_i \text{)} \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} c_i \tilde{v}_i - \sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \frac{c_i v_{i,p}}{v_{k,p}} \tilde{v}_k && \text{(distribute each } c_i, \text{ and split the sum)} \\ &= c_1 \tilde{v}_1 + \dots + c_{k-1} \tilde{v}_{k-1} - \left(\sum_{i=1}^{k-1} \frac{c_i v_{i,p}}{v_{k,p}} \right) \tilde{v}_k, && \text{(factor } \tilde{v}_k \text{ out of the second sum)} \end{aligned}$$

a combination of $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k$ equal to $\tilde{0}_p$ whose first $k-1$ coefficients are not all zero. $\square$

Example 0.17 (Three vectors in $\mathbb{R}^2$). Theorem 0.15 says the three vectors $(1, 0)$, $(0, 1)$ and $(1, 1)$ in $\mathbb{R}^2$ are linearly dependent, and indeed $1 \cdot (1, 0) + 1 \cdot (0, 1) - 1 \cdot (1, 1) = (0, 0)$. The theorem says nothing about $k \leq p$ vectors: $(1, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$ are linearly independent, while $(1, 2)$ and $(2, 4)$ are not (Example 0.8).

Definition 0.30 (Basis). A **basis** of a subspace $\mathcal{S}$ (Definition 0.28) is a list of vectors that are linearly independent (Definition 0.25) and span $\mathcal{S}$ (Definition 0.29).

Example 0.18 (Two bases of $\mathbb{R}^2$).

- $(1, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$ form a basis of $\mathbb{R}^2$: they are linearly independent, and any $(x, y) \in \mathbb{R}^2$ equals $x(1, 0) + y(0, 1)$.
- $(1, 0)$ and $(1, 1)$ also form a basis of $\mathbb{R}^2$: Example 0.8 shows they are linearly independent, and any (x, y) equals $(x - y)(1, 0) + y(1, 1)$, because $(x - y) + y = x$.

in the first entry and $0 + y = y$ in the second.

Example 0.19 (Lists that are not bases of $\mathbb{R}^2$).

- $(1, 0)$ and $(2, 0)$ are not a basis of $\mathbb{R}^2$. They are not linearly independent, since $2(1, 0) - (2, 0) = \tilde{0}$, and they do not span $\mathbb{R}^2$: every combination $c_1(1, 0) + c_2(2, 0)$ has second entry 0, so $(0, 1)$ is not in their span.
- $(1, 0)$, $(0, 1)$ and $(1, 1)$ span $\mathbb{R}^2$, but they are not a basis: $(1, 0) + (0, 1) - (1, 1) = \tilde{0}$, so they are not linearly independent.

Theorem 0.16 (Coordinates in a basis are unique). *If $\tilde{a}_1, \dots, \tilde{a}_k$ is a basis of a subspace $\mathcal{S}$ (Definition 0.30), then every $\tilde{x} \in \mathcal{S}$ is a linear combination $\tilde{x} = c_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + c_k\tilde{a}_k$ for exactly one list of numbers $c_1, \dots, c_k$.*

Proof

Proof. At least one such list exists, because the basis spans $\mathcal{S}$ (Definition 0.29). Suppose two lists both work:

$$c_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + c_k\tilde{a}_k = \tilde{x} = d_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + d_k\tilde{a}_k.$$

Subtracting the right side from the left side gives

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{0} &= (c_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + c_k\tilde{a}_k) - (d_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + d_k\tilde{a}_k) \quad (\text{both combinations equal } \tilde{x}) \\ &= (c_1 - d_1)\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + (c_k - d_k)\tilde{a}_k \quad (\text{regroup, and distribute each } \tilde{a}_i) \end{aligned}$$

Because $\tilde{a}_1, \dots, \tilde{a}_k$ are linearly independent (Definition 0.25), every coefficient $c_i - d_i$ is 0, so $c_i = d_i$ for each i . $\square$

Example 0.20 (Coordinates of $(3, 5)$ in two bases). In the basis $(1, 0), (0, 1)$ of Example 0.18, $(3, 5) = 3(1, 0) + 5(0, 1)$, and no other coefficients work. In the basis $(1, 0), (1, 1)$, the formula in Example 0.18 gives $(3, 5) = (3 - 5)(1, 0) + 5(1, 1) = -2(1, 0) + 5(1, 1)$. The same vector has different coordinates in different bases, but within one basis its coordinates are unique.

The list $(1, 0), (0, 1), (1, 1)$ in Example 0.19 spans $\mathbb{R}^2$ but is not linearly independent, and its coordinates are not unique: $(3, 5) = 3(1, 0) + 5(0, 1) + 0(1, 1) = 0(1, 0) + 2(0, 1) + 3(1, 1)$.

Theorem 0.17 (All bases of a subspace have the same number of vectors). *If $\tilde{a}_1, \dots, \tilde{a}_k$ and $\tilde{b}_1, \dots, \tilde{b}_l$ are both bases of a subspace $\mathcal{S}$ of $\mathbb{R}^p$ (Definition 0.30), then $k = l$.*

i Proof

Proof. Let $\mathbf{A}$ be the $p \times k$ matrix with columns $\tilde{a}_1, \dots, \tilde{a}_k$, and $\mathbf{B}$ the $p \times l$ matrix with columns $\tilde{b}_1, \dots, \tilde{b}_l$.

Write $\mathbf{A}$ in terms of $\mathbf{B}$. Each $\tilde{a}_j$ is in $\mathcal{S}$, and the $\tilde{b}$'s span $\mathcal{S}$ (Definition 0.29), so $\tilde{a}_j = \mathbf{B}\tilde{c}_j$ for some $\tilde{c}_j \in \mathbb{R}^l$ (Definition 0.21). Let $\mathbf{C}$ be the $l \times k$ matrix with columns $\tilde{c}_1, \dots, \tilde{c}_k$. Then $\underset{p \times k}{\mathbf{A}} = \underset{p \times l}{\mathbf{B}} \underset{l \times k}{\mathbf{C}}$, because column j of $\mathbf{BC}$ is $\mathbf{B}\tilde{c}_j$.

The columns of $\mathbf{C}$ are linearly independent. Suppose $\mathbf{C}\tilde{x} = \tilde{0}$ for some $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^k$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{A}\tilde{x} &= (\mathbf{BC})\tilde{x} \quad (\text{substitute } \mathbf{A} = \mathbf{BC}) \\ &= \mathbf{B}(\mathbf{C}\tilde{x}) \quad (\text{@thm-matmul-assoc}) \\ &= \mathbf{B}\tilde{0} \quad (\text{substitute } \mathbf{C}\tilde{x} = \tilde{0}) \\ &= \tilde{0} \quad (\text{a matrix times the zero vector is } \tilde{0}) \end{aligned}$$

$\mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$ is the combination $x_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + x_k\tilde{a}_k$ (Theorem 0.13), and the $\tilde{a}$'s are linearly independent (Definition 0.25), so $\tilde{x} = \tilde{0}$. So the only combination of the columns of $\mathbf{C}$ that equals $\tilde{0}$ has all coefficients 0.

Count. $\mathbf{C}$ has k linearly independent columns of length l . More than l vectors in $\mathbb{R}^l$ are never linearly independent (Theorem 0.15), so $k \leq l$. Exchanging the roles of the two bases gives $l \leq k$, so $k = l$. $\square$

Example 0.21 (Both bases of $\mathbb{R}^2$ in Example 0.18 have two vectors). The bases $(1, 0), (0, 1)$ and $(1, 0), (1, 1)$ of $\mathbb{R}^2$ in Example 0.18 both have 2 vectors, as Theorem 0.17 requires. So no list of 3 vectors is a basis of $\mathbb{R}^2$, which agrees with Example 0.19: the list $(1, 0), (0, 1), (1, 1)$ spans $\mathbb{R}^2$ but is not linearly independent.

Definition 0.31 (Dimension). The **dimension** of a subspace $\mathcal{S}$, written $\dim(\mathcal{S})$, is the number of vectors in any basis of $\mathcal{S}$ (Definition 0.30). Theorem 0.17 makes this number well defined. By convention, the empty list is the basis of $\{\tilde{0}\}$, so $\dim(\{\tilde{0}\}) = 0$.

Example 0.22 (The dimensions of some subspaces).

- $\dim(\{\tilde{0}\}) = 0$, by the convention in Definition 0.31.
- $\dim(\mathbb{R}^2) = 2$, by Example 0.18. More generally, $\dim(\mathbb{R}^p) = p$: the indicator vectors $\tilde{e}_1, \dots, \tilde{e}_p$ (Definition 0.9) are linearly independent, since $c_1\tilde{e}_1 + \dots + c_p\tilde{e}_p = (c_1, \dots, c_p)$, which is $\tilde{0}_p$ only if every $c_i = 0$; and they span $\mathbb{R}^p$, since any $\tilde{x} = x_1\tilde{e}_1 + \dots + x_p\tilde{e}_p$.
- The line in Example 0.10 has dimension 1: the single vector $(1, 2)$ is linearly independent and spans the line.

- The plane $z = 0$ in Example 0.13 has dimension 2, with basis $(1, 0, 0), (0, 1, 0)$.

Theorem 0.18 (Adding a vector outside the span keeps a list independent). *If $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k$ are linearly independent (Definition 0.25) and $\tilde{w}$ is not in $\text{span}\{\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k\}$ (Definition 0.29), then $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k, \tilde{w}$ are linearly independent.*

i Proof

Proof. Suppose $c_1\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + c_k\tilde{v}_k + d\tilde{w} = \tilde{0}$.

The coefficient d is 0. If $d \neq 0$, then

$$\begin{aligned}\tilde{w} &= \frac{1}{d}(d\tilde{w}) && (d \neq 0) \\ &= \frac{1}{d}(-c_1\tilde{v}_1 - \dots - c_k\tilde{v}_k) && (\text{solve the supposed equation for } d\tilde{w}) \\ &= \left(-\frac{c_1}{d}\right)\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + \left(-\frac{c_k}{d}\right)\tilde{v}_k, && (\text{distribute } \frac{1}{d})\end{aligned}$$

which puts $\tilde{w}$ in $\text{span}\{\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k\}$, contrary to the assumption.

The other coefficients are 0. With $d = 0$, the equation reads $c_1\tilde{v}_1 + \dots + c_k\tilde{v}_k = \tilde{0}$, so every $c_i = 0$, because $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k$ are linearly independent. $\square$

Example 0.23 (Adding $(0, 0, 1)$ to two independent vectors in $\mathbb{R}^3$). The vectors $(1, 0, 0)$ and $(0, 1, 0)$ are linearly independent, and their span is the plane $z = 0$ (Example 0.13). The vector $(0, 0, 1)$ has third entry 1, so it is not in that plane, and by Theorem 0.18 the three vectors $(1, 0, 0), (0, 1, 0), (0, 0, 1)$ are linearly independent. Adding $(1, 1, 0)$ instead would not work: $(1, 1, 0)$ is in the span, and $(1, 0, 0) + (0, 1, 0) - (1, 1, 0) = \tilde{0}$.

Theorem 0.19 (An independent list extends to a basis). *If $\mathcal{S}$ is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^p$ (Definition 0.28) and $\tilde{v}_1, \dots, \tilde{v}_k \in \mathcal{S}$ are linearly independent (Definition 0.25), then adding vectors of $\mathcal{S}$ to the list gives a basis of $\mathcal{S}$ (Definition 0.30). Starting from the empty list shows that every subspace has a basis.*

i Proof

Proof. Repeat the following step. If the current list spans $\mathcal{S}$, stop: it is linearly independent and spans $\mathcal{S}$, so it is a basis. Otherwise, some $\tilde{w} \in \mathcal{S}$ is not in the span of the current list; add $\tilde{w}$ to the list, which stays linearly independent by Theorem 0.18.

Every list produced is a linearly independent list of vectors in $\mathbb{R}^p$, so it has at most p vectors (Theorem 0.15). Each step adds one vector, so the process stops after at most

$p - k$ steps, and when it stops the list is a basis of $\mathcal{S}$.

For the empty list, which is linearly independent and spans $\{\tilde{0}\}$ by the conventions in Definition 0.29, the first step asks whether $\mathcal{S} = \{\tilde{0}\}$: if so, the empty list is already a basis; if not, the process adds vectors as described. $\square$

Example 0.24 (Extending $(1, 1, 0)$ to a basis of $\mathbb{R}^3$). Start with the single vector $(1, 1, 0)$.

1. $(1, 0, 0)$ is not in $\text{span}\{(1, 1, 0)\}$, because every multiple $c(1, 1, 0)$ has equal first and second entries. Add it.
2. $(0, 0, 1)$ is not in $\text{span}\{(1, 1, 0), (1, 0, 0)\}$, because every combination of those two vectors has third entry 0. Add it.
3. The list $(1, 1, 0), (1, 0, 0), (0, 0, 1)$ spans $\mathbb{R}^3$: $(x, y, z) = y(1, 1, 0) + (x - y)(1, 0, 0) + z(0, 0, 1)$. Stop.

The result is a basis of $\mathbb{R}^3$ that contains the starting vector.

Theorem 0.20 (An independent list in a subspace has at most $\dim$ vectors). *Let $\mathcal{S}$ be a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^p$ with $\dim(\mathcal{S}) = d$ (Definition 0.31).*

1. Any linearly independent list of vectors in $\mathcal{S}$ has at most d vectors.
2. If $\mathcal{T}$ is a subspace with $\mathcal{T} \subseteq \mathcal{S}$, then $\dim(\mathcal{T}) \leq \dim(\mathcal{S})$.

i Proof

Proof. Part 1. If $d = 0$, then $\mathcal{S} = \{\tilde{0}\}$, so every vector in a nonempty list from $\mathcal{S}$ is $\tilde{0}$, and $1 \cdot \tilde{0} = \tilde{0}$ shows the list is not linearly independent; only the empty list, with $0 = d$ vectors, is. Now let $d \geq 1$, and let $\tilde{a}_1, \dots, \tilde{a}_d$ be a basis of $\mathcal{S}$, and let $\tilde{u}_1, \dots, \tilde{u}_k \in \mathcal{S}$ be linearly independent. Each $\tilde{u}_j$ is in $\mathcal{S}$, so $\tilde{u}_j = c_{1j}\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + c_{dj}\tilde{a}_d$ for some coordinate vector $\tilde{c}_j = (c_{1j}, \dots, c_{dj}) \in \mathbb{R}^d$. Suppose $k > d$. Then $\tilde{c}_1, \dots, \tilde{c}_k$ are $k > d$ vectors in $\mathbb{R}^d$, so some $x_1, \dots, x_k$, not all zero, satisfy $x_1\tilde{c}_1 + \dots + x_k\tilde{c}_k = \tilde{0}_d$ (Theorem 0.15); entry i of that equation says $\sum_{j=1}^k x_j c_{ij} = 0$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{j=1}^k x_j \tilde{u}_j &= \sum_{j=1}^k x_j \sum_{i=1}^d c_{ij} \tilde{a}_i && \text{(substitute each } \tilde{u}_j \text{)} \\
&= \sum_{j=1}^k \sum_{i=1}^d x_j c_{ij} \tilde{a}_i && \text{(distribute each } x_j \text{ over the inner sum)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^d \sum_{j=1}^k x_j c_{ij} \tilde{a}_i && \text{(swap the order of the finite sums)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^d \left(\sum_{j=1}^k x_j c_{ij} \right) \tilde{a}_i && \text{(factor } \tilde{a}_i \text{ out of the inner sum)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^d 0 \cdot \tilde{a}_i && \text{(entry } i \text{ of } \sum_j x_j \tilde{c}_j = \tilde{0}_d \text{)} \\
&= \tilde{0}_p, && \text{(a zero multiple of a vector is } \tilde{0} \text{)}
\end{aligned}$$

a combination of $\tilde{u}_1, \dots, \tilde{u}_k$ with coefficients not all zero that equals $\tilde{0}_p$. That contradicts their linear independence, so $k \leq d$.

Part 2. $\mathcal{T}$ has a basis (Theorem 0.19) with $\dim(\mathcal{T})$ vectors. Those vectors are linearly independent and lie in $\mathcal{S}$, so by Part 1 there are at most $\dim(\mathcal{S})$ of them. $\square$

Example 0.25 (Subspaces of a plane have dimension at most two). The plane $\mathcal{S} = \{(x, y, 0) : x, y \in \mathbb{R}\}$ in $\mathbb{R}^3$ has dimension 2 (Example 0.22). By Theorem 0.20, no three vectors with third entry 0 are linearly independent; for instance, $(1, 0, 0) + (0, 1, 0) - (1, 1, 0) = \tilde{0}$. The line $\mathcal{T} = \text{span}\{(1, 1, 0)\}$ lies in $\mathcal{S}$, and $\dim(\mathcal{T}) = 1 \leq 2 = \dim(\mathcal{S})$.

Column space and null space

Definition 0.32 (Column space). The **column space** of an $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is

$$\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \{\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} : \tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n\},$$

the set of all vectors $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$ in $\mathbb{R}^m$. It is also called the **range** or **image** of $\mathbf{A}$. The **row space** of $\mathbf{A}$ is $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}^\top)$, a set of vectors in $\mathbb{R}^n$.

Example 0.26 (The column space of a rank-one matrix). Let

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & -2 \\ 3 & -6 & -6 \end{bmatrix}.$$

For any $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^3$, $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = (x_1 - 2x_2 - 2x_3, 3(x_1 - 2x_2 - 2x_3)) = (x_1 - 2x_2 - 2x_3)(1, 3)$

(Definition 0.21). The number $x_1 - 2x_2 - 2x_3$ can be any real number (take $x_2 = x_3 = 0$), so $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}) = \{c(1, 3) : c \in \mathbb{R}\}$, a line in $\mathbb{R}^2$. The vector $(1, 0)$ is not in $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$: $c(1, 3)$ has second entry $3c$, which is 0 only if $c = 0$, and then the first entry is 0, not 1.

Theorem 0.21 (The column space is the span of the columns). *If $\mathbf{A}$ is an $m \times n$ matrix with columns $\tilde{a}_1, \dots, \tilde{a}_n$, then*

$$\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{span}\{\tilde{a}_1, \dots, \tilde{a}_n\},$$

so $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$ is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^m$, and the row space $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}^\top)$ is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^n$.

i Proof

Proof. By Theorem 0.13, $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = x_1\tilde{a}_1 + \dots + x_n\tilde{a}_n$, and as $\tilde{x}$ ranges over $\mathbb{R}^n$, the coefficients $x_1, \dots, x_n$ range over all lists of n numbers. So the set of all $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x}$ (Definition 0.32) is the set of all linear combinations of the columns, which is their span (Definition 0.29). A span is a subspace (Theorem 0.12). Applying the same argument to $\mathbf{A}^\top$, whose columns are the rows of $\mathbf{A}$, shows the row space is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^n$. $\square$

Example 0.27 (Reading off the column space and row space from the columns and rows). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26, the columns are $(1, 3)$, $(-2, -6) = -2(1, 3)$ and $(-2, -6) = -2(1, 3)$, so by Theorem 0.21 $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{span}\{(1, 3)\}$, the same line found in Example 0.26. The rows are $(1, -2, -2)$ and $(3, -6, -6) = 3(1, -2, -2)$, so the row space is $\text{span}\{(1, -2, -2)\}$, a line in $\mathbb{R}^3$.

Definition 0.33 (Null space). The **null space** of an $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is

$$\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \{\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n : \mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = \tilde{0}_m\},$$

the set of solutions of $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = \tilde{0}_m$. It is also called the **kernel** of $\mathbf{A}$. The **left null space** of $\mathbf{A}$ is $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}^\top)$, a set of vectors in $\mathbb{R}^m$.

Example 0.28 (The null space and left null space of a rank-one matrix). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26, $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = (x_1 - 2x_2 - 2x_3, 3(x_1 - 2x_2 - 2x_3))$, so $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = \tilde{0}_2$ exactly when $x_1 = 2x_2 + 2x_3$. Writing $\tilde{x} = (2x_2 + 2x_3, x_2, x_3) = x_2(2, 1, 0) + x_3(2, 0, 1)$ shows $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{span}\{(2, 1, 0), (2, 0, 1)\}$, a plane in $\mathbb{R}^3$. For the left null space, $\mathbf{A}^\top\tilde{y} = (y_1 + 3y_2, -2(y_1 + 3y_2), -2(y_1 + 3y_2))$, which is $\tilde{0}_3$ exactly when $y_1 = -3y_2$, so $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}^\top) = \text{span}\{(-3, 1)\}$, a line in $\mathbb{R}^2$.

Theorem 0.22 (A null space is a subspace). *For any $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$, $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$ (Definition 0.33) is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^n$ (Definition 0.28).*

i Proof

Proof. $\mathbf{A}\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m$, so $\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n \in \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$, and the null space is not empty. If $\tilde{u}, \tilde{w} \in \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$ and $c \in \mathbb{R}$, then

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{A}(\tilde{u} + \tilde{w}) &= \mathbf{A}\tilde{u} + \mathbf{A}\tilde{w} && \text{(@thm-matmul-distrib)} \\ &= \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m + \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m && (\tilde{u} \text{ and } \tilde{w} \text{ are in the null space)} \\ &= \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m && (\text{adding } \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m \text{ changes nothing}) \end{aligned}$$

and, for each entry $i = 1, \dots, m$,

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{A}(c\tilde{u}))_i &= a_{i1}(cu_1) + \dots + a_{in}(cu_n) && \text{(@def-matvec-mult)} \\ &= c(a_{i1}u_1 + \dots + a_{in}u_n) && (\text{factor } c \text{ out of each term)} \\ &= c(\mathbf{A}\tilde{u})_i && \text{(@def-matvec-mult)} \\ &= c \cdot 0 && (\tilde{u} \text{ is in the null space)} \\ &= 0, && (\text{arithmetic}) \end{aligned}$$

so $\mathbf{A}(c\tilde{u}) = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m$. Therefore $\tilde{u} + \tilde{w}$ and $c\tilde{u}$ are in $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$. □

Example 0.29 (The solutions of $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = \tilde{b}$ with $\tilde{b} \neq \tilde{\mathbf{0}}$ are not a subspace). In Example 0.28, $(2, 1, 0)$ and $(2, 0, 1)$ are in $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$, and so is their sum $(4, 1, 1)$, since $4 - 2 \cdot 1 - 2 \cdot 1 = 0$. By contrast, the solutions of $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = (1, 3)$ for the same $\mathbf{A}$ are the vectors with $x_1 - 2x_2 - 2x_3 = 1$. That set does not contain $\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_3$, so by Theorem 0.11 it is not a subspace.

Theorem 0.23 (The row space and null space share only the zero vector). *For any $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$,*

$$\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}^\top) \cap \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}) = \{\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n\}.$$

i Proof

Proof. Both sets are subspaces, by Theorem 0.21 and Theorem 0.22, so both contain $\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n$ (Theorem 0.11).

Now take any $\tilde{x}$ in both sets. Being in the row space means $\tilde{x} = \mathbf{A}^\top \tilde{u}$ for some $\tilde{u} \in \mathbb{R}^m$ (Definition 0.32), and being in the null space means $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m$ (Definition 0.33). Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{x}^\top \tilde{x} &= (\mathbf{A}^\top \tilde{u})^\top \tilde{x} && \text{(substitute } \tilde{x} = \mathbf{A}^\top \tilde{u} \text{ in the first factor)} \\
&= (\tilde{u}^\top (\mathbf{A}^\top)^\top) \tilde{x} && \text{(@thm-transpose-product)} \\
&= (\tilde{u}^\top \mathbf{A}) \tilde{x} && \text{(transposing twice returns the original matrix)} \\
&= \tilde{u}^\top (\mathbf{A} \tilde{x}) && \text{(@thm-matmul-assoc)} \\
&= \tilde{u}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m && \text{(substitute } \mathbf{A} \tilde{x} = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m \text{)} \\
&= 0. && \text{(every term of the inner product is 0)}
\end{aligned}$$

But $\tilde{x}^\top \tilde{x} = x_1^2 + \dots + x_n^2$, which is 0 only when every $x_i = 0$. So $\tilde{x} = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n$. $\square$

Example 0.30 (The row space and null space in Example 0.28). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26, the row space is $\text{span}\{(1, -2, -2)\}$ and the null space is $\text{span}\{(2, 1, 0), (2, 0, 1)\}$ (Example 0.28). A vector $c(1, -2, -2)$ of the row space is in the null space only if

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{A}(c(1, -2, -2)) &= c(1 - 2 \cdot (-2) - 2 \cdot (-2), 3(1 - 2 \cdot (-2) - 2 \cdot (-2))) && \text{(@exm-null-space's formula for } \mathbf{A}\tilde{x}) \\
&= c(9, 27) && \text{(arithmetic)}
\end{aligned}$$

is $\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_2$, that is, only if $c = 0$. So the two subspaces share only $\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_3$.

Theorem 0.24 ($\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$ has the same null space as $\mathbf{A}$). For any $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$,

$$\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}).$$

Proof

Proof. $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}) \subseteq \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A})$. If $\mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m$, then $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = \mathbf{A}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n$.
 $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}) \subseteq \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$. If $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}\tilde{x} = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n$, then

$$\begin{aligned}
0 &= \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n && \text{(every term of the inner product is 0)} \\
&= \tilde{x}^\top (\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x}) && \text{(substitute } \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n = \mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x}) \\
&= (\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{A}^\top) (\mathbf{A} \tilde{x}) && \text{(@thm-matmul-assoc)} \\
&= (\mathbf{A} \tilde{x})^\top (\mathbf{A} \tilde{x}) && \text{(@thm-transpose-product)} \\
&= (\mathbf{A} \tilde{x}) \cdot (\mathbf{A} \tilde{x}) && \text{(@exm-dot-product-matmul)} \\
&= \|\mathbf{A} \tilde{x}\|^2. && \text{(square both sides of @eq-l2-norm)}
\end{aligned}$$

A vector whose Euclidean norm is 0 has every entry 0, so $\mathbf{A} \tilde{x} = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m$. $\square$

Example 0.31 (The null space of a Gram matrix). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26,

$$\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ -2 & -6 \\ -2 & -6 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & -2 \\ 3 & -6 & -6 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 10 & -20 & -20 \\ -20 & 40 & 40 \\ -20 & 40 & 40 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Every row is a multiple of $(1, -2, -2)$, so $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x} = \tilde{0}_3$ exactly when $x_1 - 2x_2 - 2x_3 = 0$, the same condition as for $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$ in Example 0.28.

Rank-nullity and rank factorization

This section is adapted from Zhou (2024a), used under the MIT License (see the license text in Section).

Theorem 0.25 (The rank is the dimension of the column space). *For any $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$,*

$$\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = \dim(\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})).$$

Proof

Proof. Let $r = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A})$ (Definition 0.26), and choose r linearly independent columns of $\mathbf{A}$; by Definition 0.26, no larger set of columns is linearly independent. We show the chosen columns are a basis of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$ (Definition 0.30).

Every column is in the span of the chosen columns. A chosen column is in that span trivially. If some unchosen column $\tilde{a}_j$ were not in the span, then adding it to the chosen columns would give $r + 1$ linearly independent columns (Theorem 0.18), more than r . So every column of $\mathbf{A}$ is in the span of the chosen columns.

The chosen columns span $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$. The span of the chosen columns is a subspace (Theorem 0.12), so it is closed under addition and scalar multiplication, and it contains every linear combination of the columns of $\mathbf{A}$. By Theorem 0.21, those combinations make up $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$, so $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$ is contained in the span of the chosen columns. The chosen columns are themselves columns of $\mathbf{A}$, so their span is contained in $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$, and the two sets are equal.

The chosen columns are linearly independent and span $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$, so they are a basis of it, and $\dim(\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})) = r$ (Definition 0.31). If $r = 0$, every column is $\tilde{0}_m$, $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}) = \{\tilde{0}_m\}$, and both sides are 0. $\square$

Example 0.32 (The rank of the matrix in Example 0.26). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26, $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{span}\{(1, 3)\}$ (Example 0.27), and $(1, 3)$ is linearly independent because it is

nonzero, so it is a basis and $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$ has dimension 1. So $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = 1$, by Theorem 0.25. Directly: the first column $(1, 3)$ is linearly independent on its own, and any two columns are dependent, because each column is a multiple of $(1, 3)$.

Definition 0.34 (Nullity). The **nullity** of a matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is the dimension of its null space (Definition 0.33):

$$\text{nullity}(\mathbf{A}) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \dim(\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})).$$

Example 0.33 (The nullity of the matrix in Example 0.26). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26, $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{span}\{(2, 1, 0), (2, 0, 1)\}$ (Example 0.28). Those two vectors are linearly independent: $c_1(2, 1, 0) + c_2(2, 0, 1) = (2c_1 + 2c_2, c_1, c_2)$, which is $\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_3$ only if $c_1 = c_2 = 0$. So they are a basis of $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$, and $\text{nullity}(\mathbf{A}) = 2$. The 2×2 identity matrix has nullity 0, because $\mathbf{I}\tilde{x} = \tilde{x}$ is $\tilde{\mathbf{0}}_2$ only when $\tilde{x} = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_2$.

Theorem 0.26 (Rank-nullity theorem). For any $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$,

$$\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) + \text{nullity}(\mathbf{A}) = n.$$

i Proof

Proof. Let $\nu = \text{nullity}(\mathbf{A})$. Choose a basis $\tilde{x}_1, \dots, \tilde{x}_\nu$ of $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$, and extend it to a basis $\tilde{x}_1, \dots, \tilde{x}_\nu, \tilde{y}_1, \dots, \tilde{y}_{n-\nu}$ of $\mathbb{R}^n$ (Theorem 0.19); it has n vectors, because every basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$ has $\dim(\mathbb{R}^n) = n$ vectors (Theorem 0.17, Example 0.22). We show that $\mathbf{A}\tilde{y}_1, \dots, \mathbf{A}\tilde{y}_{n-\nu}$ are a basis of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$, using Theorem 0.14 to apply $\mathbf{A}$ to linear combinations.

They are linearly independent. Suppose $\sum_{i=1}^{n-\nu} v_i \mathbf{A}\tilde{y}_i = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m$. Then $\mathbf{A}(\sum_i v_i \tilde{y}_i) = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_m$ (Theorem 0.14), so $\sum_i v_i \tilde{y}_i \in \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$, and it equals $\sum_{j=1}^\nu u_j \tilde{x}_j$ for some numbers u_j , since the $\tilde{x}_j$ span $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$. Moving everything to one side,

$$\sum_{j=1}^\nu (-u_j) \tilde{x}_j + \sum_{i=1}^{n-\nu} v_i \tilde{y}_i = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_n,$$

and because the $\tilde{x}$'s and $\tilde{y}$'s together form a basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$, which is linearly independent, every coefficient is 0; in particular every $v_i = 0$.

They span $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$. Take any $\tilde{w} \in \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$, so $\tilde{w} = \mathbf{A}\tilde{z}$ for some $\tilde{z} \in \mathbb{R}^n$ (Definition 0.32). Write $\tilde{z} = \sum_j a_j \tilde{x}_j + \sum_i b_i \tilde{y}_i$ in the basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{w} &= \mathbf{A} \left(\sum_{j=1}^{\nu} a_j \tilde{x}_j + \sum_{i=1}^{n-\nu} b_i \tilde{y}_i \right) && \text{(substitute } \tilde{z} \text{)} \\
&= \sum_{j=1}^{\nu} a_j \mathbf{A} \tilde{x}_j + \sum_{i=1}^{n-\nu} b_i \mathbf{A} \tilde{y}_i && \text{(@thm-matvec-linear)} \\
&= \sum_{j=1}^{\nu} a_j \tilde{0}_m + \sum_{i=1}^{n-\nu} b_i \mathbf{A} \tilde{y}_i && \text{(each } \tilde{x}_j \in \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}) \text{)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^{n-\nu} b_i \mathbf{A} \tilde{y}_i, && \text{(drop the zero terms)}
\end{aligned}$$

a linear combination of $\mathbf{A} \tilde{y}_1, \dots, \mathbf{A} \tilde{y}_{n-\nu}$. These vectors are in $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$, so their span is exactly $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$.

So $\dim(\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})) = n - \nu$, and $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = n - \nu$ by Theorem 0.25. $\square$

Example 0.34 (Checking rank-nullity on the matrix in Example 0.26). The matrix $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26 has $n = 3$ columns, rank 1 (Example 0.32) and nullity 2 (Example 0.33), and $1 + 2 = 3$. The 2×2 identity matrix has rank 2 and nullity 0 (Example 0.33), and $2 + 0 = 2$.

Theorem 0.27 (Multiplying on the right cannot increase the rank). *If $\mathbf{A}$ is $m \times n$ and $\mathbf{B}$ is $n \times k$, then*

$$\text{rank}(\mathbf{AB}) \leq \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}).$$

i Proof

Proof. $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{AB}) \subseteq \mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$. Any vector in $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{AB})$ is $(\mathbf{AB}) \tilde{x}$ for some $\tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^k$ (Definition 0.32), and

$$(\mathbf{AB}) \tilde{x} = \mathbf{A}(\mathbf{B} \tilde{x}) \quad \text{(@thm-matmul-assoc)}$$

is $\mathbf{A}$ times the vector $\mathbf{B} \tilde{x} \in \mathbb{R}^n$, so it is in $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$.

Compare dimensions. Both column spaces are subspaces (Theorem 0.21), so

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{rank}(\mathbf{AB}) &= \dim(\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{AB})) && \text{(@thm-rank-dim)} \\
&\leq \dim(\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})) && \text{(@thm-dim-bound, part 2)} \\
&= \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}). && \text{(@thm-rank-dim)}
\end{aligned}$$

$\square$

Example 0.35 (A product can lose rank). Let

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{AB} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot 0 \\ 0 \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

$\mathbf{A}$ has rank 1, but $\mathbf{AB}$ has rank 0, so the inequality in Theorem 0.27 can be strict. With the 2×2 identity in place of $\mathbf{B}$, $\mathbf{AI} = \mathbf{A}$ keeps rank 1, and the inequality is an equality.

Theorem 0.28 (Fundamental theorem of ranks). *For any $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$,*

$$\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}^\top) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A} \mathbf{A}^\top).$$

In particular, the largest number of linearly independent rows of $\mathbf{A}$ equals the largest number of linearly independent columns.

Proof

Proof. $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A})$. Both matrices have n columns, and $\mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}) = \mathcal{N}(\mathbf{A})$ (Theorem 0.24), so they have the same nullity (Definition 0.34). Then

$$\begin{aligned} \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}) &= n - \text{nullity}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}) \quad (\text{@thm-rank-nullity}) \\ &= n - \text{nullity}(\mathbf{A}) \quad (\text{equal null spaces}) \\ &= \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}). \quad (\text{@thm-rank-nullity}) \end{aligned}$$

$\text{rank}(\mathbf{A} \mathbf{A}^\top) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}^\top)$. Apply the previous step to the $n \times m$ matrix $\mathbf{A}^\top$, using $(\mathbf{A}^\top)^\top = \mathbf{A}$.

Chain the inequalities.

$$\begin{aligned} \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) &= \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}) \quad (\text{first step}) \\ &\leq \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}^\top) \quad (\text{@thm-rank-product, with } \mathbf{A}^\top \text{ on the left}) \\ &= \text{rank}(\mathbf{A} \mathbf{A}^\top) \quad (\text{second step}) \\ &\leq \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}). \quad (\text{@thm-rank-product, with } \mathbf{A} \text{ on the left}) \end{aligned}$$

The chain starts and ends at $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A})$, so every quantity in it equals $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A})$. The columns of $\mathbf{A}^\top$ are the rows of $\mathbf{A}$, which gives the statement about rows. $\square$

Example 0.36 (Four equal ranks). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26, $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = 1$ (Example 0.32).

Its transpose $\mathbf{A}^\top = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ -2 & -6 \\ -2 & -6 \end{bmatrix}$ has second column 3 times its first, so its rank is 1. $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$

in Example 0.31 has every row a multiple of $(1, -2, -2)$, so its rank is 1 too, and

$$\mathbf{A}\mathbf{A}^\top = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + (-2)(-2) + (-2)(-2) & 1 \cdot 3 + (-2)(-6) + (-2)(-6) \\ 3 \cdot 1 + (-6)(-2) + (-6)(-2) & 3 \cdot 3 + (-6)(-6) + (-6)(-6) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 9 & 27 \\ 27 & 81 \end{bmatrix},$$

whose second column is 3 times its first, so its rank is 1.

Corollary 0.1 (The rank is at most the smaller dimension). *For any $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$, $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) \leq \min\{m, n\}$.*

i Proof

Proof. $\mathbf{A}$ has n columns, so at most n of them are linearly independent, and $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) \leq n$ (Definition 0.26). Likewise $\mathbf{A}^\top$ has m columns, so $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = \text{rank}(\mathbf{A}^\top) \leq m$ (Theorem 0.28). $\square$

Example 0.37 (A 2×3 matrix has rank at most 2). By Corollary 0.1, every 2×3 matrix has rank at most $\min\{2, 3\} = 2$, even though it has 3 columns. The matrix $\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ of Remark 0.13 reaches that bound: its first two columns $(1, 0)$ and $(0, 1)$ are linearly independent, so its rank is 2.

Definition 0.35 (Rank factorization). Let $\mathbf{A}$ be an $m \times n$ matrix with $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = r \geq 1$. A **rank factorization** of $\mathbf{A}$ is a product

$$\underset{m \times n}{\mathbf{A}} = \underset{m \times r}{\mathbf{C}} \underset{r \times n}{\mathbf{R}}.$$

Example 0.38 (A rank factorization of a rank-one matrix). The matrix $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26 has rank 1 (Example 0.32), and

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & -2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot (-2) & 1 \cdot (-2) \\ 3 \cdot 1 & 3 \cdot (-2) & 3 \cdot (-2) \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & -2 \\ 3 & -6 & -6 \end{bmatrix},$$

so $\mathbf{C} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix}$ (2×1) and $\mathbf{R} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & -2 \end{bmatrix}$ (1×3) are a rank factorization. It is not unique: $\mathbf{C} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{R} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{2} & -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$ give the same product. A product $\mathbf{C}\mathbf{R}$ with $\mathbf{C}$ of size 2×2 is not a rank factorization of this $\mathbf{A}$, because the inner dimension must equal $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = 1$.

Theorem 0.29 (Every nonzero matrix has a rank factorization). *Every $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ with $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = r \geq 1$ has a rank factorization (Definition 0.35). One is given by taking the columns of $\mathbf{C}$ to be any basis of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$.*

i Proof

Proof. $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$ has dimension r (Theorem 0.25), so it has a basis $\tilde{\mathbf{c}}_1, \dots, \tilde{\mathbf{c}}_r$ (Theorem 0.19); let $\mathbf{C}$ be the $m \times r$ matrix with these columns. Each column $\tilde{\mathbf{a}}_j$ of $\mathbf{A}$ is in $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$, so $\tilde{\mathbf{a}}_j = r_{1j}\tilde{\mathbf{c}}_1 + \dots + r_{rj}\tilde{\mathbf{c}}_r$ for some numbers r_{ij} , because the basis spans $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$. Let $\mathbf{R}$ be the $r \times n$ matrix with entries r_{ij} , whose column j is $\tilde{\mathbf{r}}_j = (r_{1j}, \dots, r_{rj})$. Then column j of $\mathbf{CR}$ is

$$\begin{aligned}\mathbf{C}\tilde{\mathbf{r}}_j &= r_{1j}\tilde{\mathbf{c}}_1 + \dots + r_{rj}\tilde{\mathbf{c}}_r && (\text{@thm-matvec-columns}) \\ &= \tilde{\mathbf{a}}_j, && (\text{choice of the } r_{ij})\end{aligned}$$

so $\mathbf{CR} = \mathbf{A}$. □

Example 0.39 (Building a rank factorization from a basis). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.26, $(1, 3)$ spans $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$ (Example 0.27), and it is linearly independent because it is nonzero ($c(1, 3) = \tilde{\mathbf{0}}_2$ forces $c = 0$), so it is a basis of $\mathcal{C}(\mathbf{A})$. The columns of $\mathbf{A}$ are $(1, 3) = 1 \cdot (1, 3)$, $(-2, -6) = -2 \cdot (1, 3)$ and $(-2, -6) = -2 \cdot (1, 3)$, so the construction in Theorem 0.29 gives $\mathbf{C} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{R} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & -2 \end{bmatrix}$, the factorization in Example 0.38.

Outer product

Definition 0.36 (Outer product). The **outer product** of a vector $\tilde{\mathbf{u}}$ of length m and a vector $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}$ of length n is the $m \times n$ matrix product (Definition 0.20) $\tilde{\mathbf{u}}\tilde{\mathbf{v}}^\top$ of the column vector $\tilde{\mathbf{u}}$ with the row vector $\tilde{\mathbf{v}}^\top$. Its entries are

$$\left(\underbrace{\tilde{\mathbf{u}}}_{m \times 1} \underbrace{\tilde{\mathbf{v}}^\top}_{1 \times n} \right)_{ij} = u_i v_j \quad (\text{definition of matrix multiplication; the sum has one term})$$

Example 0.40 (An outer product). For $\tilde{\mathbf{u}} = (1, 2, 3)$ and $\tilde{\mathbf{v}} = (4, 5)$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{u} \tilde{v}^\top &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 5 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of the outer product)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 4 & 1 \cdot 5 \\ 2 \cdot 4 & 2 \cdot 5 \\ 3 \cdot 4 & 3 \cdot 5 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(entry } (i, j) \text{ is } u_i v_j) \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 5 \\ 8 & 10 \\ 12 & 15 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)}
\end{aligned}$$

Remark 0.14 (Outer product and dot product). The dot product $\tilde{u}^\top \tilde{v}$ (Example 0.7) needs two vectors of the same length and gives a number. The outer product $\tilde{u} \tilde{v}^\top$ takes vectors of any two lengths and gives a matrix (Banerjee and Roy 2014, chap. 1, p. 11). For example, $\tilde{u} = (1, 2, 3)$ and $\tilde{v} = (4, 5)$ in Example 0.40 have different lengths, so they have no dot product, but their outer product is a 3×2 matrix. For $\tilde{a} = (1, 2)$ and $\tilde{b} = (3, 4)$, which have the same length, both products exist:

$$\tilde{a}^\top \tilde{b} = 1 \cdot 3 + 2 \cdot 4 = 11 \quad \tilde{a} \tilde{b}^\top = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 3 & 1 \cdot 4 \\ 2 \cdot 3 & 2 \cdot 4 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 4 \\ 6 & 8 \end{bmatrix}$$

Theorem 0.30 (An outer product has rank one). *If $\tilde{u}$ is a nonzero vector of length m and $\tilde{v}$ is a nonzero vector of length n , then $\text{rank}(\tilde{u} \tilde{v}^\top) = 1$ (Definition 0.26).*

i Proof

Proof. Column j of $\tilde{u} \tilde{v}^\top$ has entries $u_1 v_j, \dots, u_m v_j$, so it is the vector $v_j \tilde{u}$.

The rank is at least one. Because $\tilde{v} \neq \tilde{0}$, some entry v_j is nonzero. Then column j , $v_j \tilde{u}$, is a nonzero vector, and a single nonzero vector is linearly independent (Definition 0.25): $c(v_j \tilde{u}) = \tilde{0}$ forces $c = 0$.

The rank is at most one. Take any two columns $j \neq k$. If $v_j = v_k = 0$, both columns are $\tilde{0}$, and $1 \cdot (v_j \tilde{u}) + 1 \cdot (v_k \tilde{u}) = \tilde{0}$. Otherwise, use the coefficients $c_j = v_k$ and $c_k = -v_j$, which are not both zero:

$$\begin{aligned}
v_k(v_j \tilde{u}) - v_j(v_k \tilde{u}) &= (v_k v_j - v_j v_k) \tilde{u} && \text{(collect the scalar multiples of } \tilde{u}) \\
&= 0 \cdot \tilde{u} && \text{(multiplication of numbers is commutative)} \\
&= \tilde{0} && \text{(a zero multiple of a vector is } \tilde{0})
\end{aligned}$$

Either way, every pair of columns has a combination with coefficients that are not all

zero and that equals $\tilde{0}$. Now take any set of two or more columns. It contains a pair $j \neq k$. Use that pair's coefficients for columns j and k , and the coefficient 0 for every other column in the set. This combination equals $\tilde{0}$, and its coefficients are not all zero, so the set is not linearly independent (Definition 0.25). The largest linearly independent set of columns therefore has one column. $\square$

Example 0.41 (The rank of an outer product). In Example 0.40, the second column $(5, 10, 15)$ of $\tilde{u} \tilde{v}^\top$ is $\frac{5}{4}$ times the first column $(4, 8, 12)$, because the columns are $v_1 \tilde{u} = 4\tilde{u}$ and $v_2 \tilde{u} = 5\tilde{u}$. So the two columns are not linearly independent, and the 3×2 matrix has rank 1.

Special Matrices

One special matrix, the zero matrix (Definition 0.17), appeared earlier, in the section on matrix addition.

Definition 0.37 (Square matrix). A matrix is **square** if it has the same number of rows as columns.

Definition 0.38 (Order of a square matrix). The **order** of a square matrix (Definition 0.37) is its number of rows, which equals its number of columns.

Definition 0.39 (Matrix power). For a square matrix $\mathbf{A}$ of order p and a positive integer k , the k -th **power** of $\mathbf{A}$ is:

$$\mathbf{A}^k = \underbrace{\mathbf{A} \mathbf{A} \cdots \mathbf{A}}_{k \text{ copies}}$$

In particular, $\mathbf{A}^2 = \mathbf{A} \mathbf{A}$.

Definition 0.40 (Identity matrix). The $p \times p$ **identity matrix** $\mathbf{I}_p$ (or $\mathbf{I}$ when the size is clear from context) has ones on the main diagonal and zeros elsewhere:

$$(\mathbf{I}_p)_{ij} = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } i = j \\ 0 & \text{if } i \neq j \end{cases} \quad \mathbf{I}_p = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Equivalently, the entries of the identity matrix are given by the **Kronecker delta**: $(\mathbf{I}_p)_{ij} = \delta_{ij}$.

Theorem 0.31 (Identity matrix is a multiplicative identity). For any $m \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$:

$$\mathbf{A} \mathbf{I}_p = \mathbf{A}$$

$$\mathbf{I}_m \mathbf{A} = \mathbf{A}$$

Definition 0.41 (Symmetric matrix). A square matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is **symmetric** if $\mathbf{A}^\top = \mathbf{A}$, i.e., $a_{ij} = a_{ji}$ for all i and j .

Remark 0.15 (Symmetric matrices in statistics). Covariance matrices are symmetric: entry (i, j) of the covariance matrix of a random vector $\tilde{Y}$ is $\text{Cov}(Y_i, Y_j)$, and $\text{Cov}(Y_i, Y_j) = \text{Cov}(Y_j, Y_i)$. For example, if $\text{Var}(Y_1) = 4$, $\text{Var}(Y_2) = 9$, and $\text{Cov}(Y_1, Y_2) = 1$, the covariance matrix of (Y_1, Y_2) is

$$\begin{bmatrix} 4 & 1 \\ 1 & 9 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Definition 0.42 (Diagonal matrix). A square matrix $\mathbf{D}$ is a **diagonal matrix** if all off-diagonal entries are zero: $d_{ij} = 0$ whenever $i \neq j$:

$$\mathbf{D} = \begin{bmatrix} d_1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 \\ 0 & d_2 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & \cdots & d_p \end{bmatrix}$$

Remark 0.16 (diag notation). For numbers $d_1, \dots, d_p$, $\text{diag}(d_1, \dots, d_p)$ is the $p \times p$ diagonal matrix with diagonal entries $d_1, \dots, d_p$. For example,

$$\text{diag}(2, 5) = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 5 \end{bmatrix},$$

and the $p \times p$ identity matrix is $\mathbf{I}_p = \text{diag}(1, \dots, 1)$.

Definition 0.43 (Matrix inverse). For a square $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$, the **inverse** $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ (if it exists) is the unique matrix satisfying:

$$\mathbf{A} \mathbf{A}^{-1} = \mathbf{A}^{-1} \mathbf{A} = \mathbf{I}_p$$

Definition 0.44 (Invertible matrix). A $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is **invertible** (or *non-singular*) if some $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{B}$ satisfies

$$\mathbf{AB} = \mathbf{BA} = \mathbf{I}_p,$$

where $\mathbf{I}_p$ is the identity matrix (Definition 0.40). A square matrix that is not invertible is *singular*.

Example 0.42 (An invertible matrix and a singular one). The matrix $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is invertible, with $\mathbf{A}^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & -0.5 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$: multiplying out gives $\mathbf{AA}^{-1} = \mathbf{A}^{-1}\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{I}_2$. The matrix $\mathbf{M} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is singular: for any 2×2 matrix $\mathbf{C}$, the two rows of $\mathbf{MC}$ are equal, so $\mathbf{MC}$ can never be $\mathbf{I}_2$, whose two rows differ.

Remark 0.17 (Invertible matrices and inverses). Let $\mathbf{A}$ be a $p \times p$ matrix, and suppose that two $p \times p$ matrices $\mathbf{B}$ and $\mathbf{C}$ satisfy $\mathbf{AB} = \mathbf{BA} = \mathbf{I}_p$ and $\mathbf{AC} = \mathbf{CA} = \mathbf{I}_p$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{B} &= \mathbf{BI}_p && \text{(identity matrix)} \\ &= \mathbf{B}(\mathbf{AC}) && (\mathbf{AC} = \mathbf{I}_p) \\ &= (\mathbf{BA})\mathbf{C} && \text{(matrix multiplication is associative)} \\ &= \mathbf{I}_p \mathbf{C} && (\mathbf{BA} = \mathbf{I}_p) \\ &= \mathbf{C} && \text{(identity matrix)} \end{aligned}$$

The steps use Theorem 0.7 and Theorem 0.31. Since $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{C}$, at most one matrix satisfies these equations, which is the uniqueness that Definition 0.43 asserts. When $\mathbf{A}$ is invertible, the matrix $\mathbf{B}$ in Definition 0.44 is therefore the inverse $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ of $\mathbf{A}$, and $\mathbf{A}$ is invertible exactly when it has an inverse. For example, for $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ in Example 0.42, $\begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & -0.5 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is the only 2×2 matrix $\mathbf{B}$ with $\mathbf{AB} = \mathbf{BA} = \mathbf{I}_2$, so it is $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$.

Theorem 0.32 (Inverse of a product). If $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ are invertible $p \times p$ matrices, then $\mathbf{AB}$ is invertible, and

$$(\mathbf{AB})^{-1} = \mathbf{B}^{-1}\mathbf{A}^{-1}$$

i Proof

Proof. Multiply $\mathbf{AB}$ by the candidate inverse on the right:

$$\begin{aligned}
 (\mathbf{AB})(\mathbf{B}^{-1}\mathbf{A}^{-1}) &= \mathbf{A}(\mathbf{BB}^{-1})\mathbf{A}^{-1} && \text{(matrix multiplication is associative)} \\
 &= \mathbf{A}\mathbf{I}_p\mathbf{A}^{-1} && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{B}^{-1} \text{)} \\
 &= \mathbf{AA}^{-1} && \text{(identity matrix)} \\
 &= \mathbf{I}_p && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{A}^{-1} \text{)}
 \end{aligned}$$

and on the left:

$$\begin{aligned}
 (\mathbf{B}^{-1}\mathbf{A}^{-1})(\mathbf{AB}) &= \mathbf{B}^{-1}(\mathbf{A}^{-1}\mathbf{A})\mathbf{B} && \text{(matrix multiplication is associative)} \\
 &= \mathbf{B}^{-1}\mathbf{I}_p\mathbf{B} && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{A}^{-1} \text{)} \\
 &= \mathbf{B}^{-1}\mathbf{B} && \text{(identity matrix)} \\
 &= \mathbf{I}_p && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{B}^{-1} \text{)}
 \end{aligned}$$

So $\mathbf{B}^{-1}\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ satisfies Definition 0.43 for $\mathbf{AB}$. The steps use Theorem 0.7 and Theorem 0.31. $\square$

Theorem 0.33 (Inverse of a transpose). *If $\mathbf{A}$ is an invertible $p \times p$ matrix, then $\mathbf{A}^\top$ is invertible, and*

$$(\mathbf{A}^\top)^{-1} = (\mathbf{A}^{-1})^\top$$

i Proof

Proof. Multiply $\mathbf{A}^\top$ by the candidate inverse on each side:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbf{A}^\top (\mathbf{A}^{-1})^\top &= (\mathbf{A}^{-1}\mathbf{A})^\top && \text{(transpose of a product)} \\
 &= \mathbf{I}_p^\top && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{A}^{-1} \text{)} \\
 &= \mathbf{I}_p && \text{(\mathbf{I}_p \text{ is symmetric)} } \\
 (\mathbf{A}^{-1})^\top \mathbf{A}^\top &= (\mathbf{AA}^{-1})^\top && \text{(transpose of a product)} \\
 &= \mathbf{I}_p^\top && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{A}^{-1} \text{)} \\
 &= \mathbf{I}_p && \text{(\mathbf{I}_p \text{ is symmetric)} }
 \end{aligned}$$

So $(\mathbf{A}^{-1})^\top$ satisfies Definition 0.43 for $\mathbf{A}^\top$. The first step of each display is Theorem 0.10. $\square$

Example 0.43 (Inverting a transpose). For $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, Example 0.42 gives $\mathbf{A}^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & -0.5 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, so Theorem 0.33 says

$$(\mathbf{A}^\top)^{-1} = \left(\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right)^{-1} = (\mathbf{A}^{-1})^\top = \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & 0 \\ -0.5 & 1 \end{bmatrix},$$

and multiplying $\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & 0 \\ -0.5 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ out does give $\mathbf{I}_2$.

Corollary 0.2 (The inverse of a symmetric matrix is symmetric). *If $\mathbf{A}$ is symmetric and invertible, then $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ is symmetric.*

i Proof

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{A}^{-1})^\top &= (\mathbf{A}^\top)^{-1} && \text{(inverse of a transpose)} \\ &= \mathbf{A}^{-1} && (\mathbf{A} \text{ is symmetric}) \end{aligned}$$

The first step is Theorem 0.33. □

Example 0.44 (Inverting a symmetric matrix). $\mathbf{S} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is symmetric, and $\mathbf{S}^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$ is symmetric too, as Corollary 0.2 says.

Definition 0.45 (Idempotent matrix). A square matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is **idempotent** if

$$\mathbf{A}^2 = \mathbf{A}$$

Definition 0.46 (Orthogonal projection matrix). A square matrix $\mathbf{P}$ is an **orthogonal projection matrix** if it is both symmetric (Definition 0.41) and idempotent (Definition 0.45):

$$\mathbf{P}^\top = \mathbf{P} \quad \text{and} \quad \mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P}$$

Definition 0.47 (Oblique projection). A square matrix is an **oblique projection** if it is idempotent (Definition 0.45) but not symmetric (Definition 0.41).

Example 0.45 (An orthogonal projection and an oblique one). $\mathbf{P} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$ is symmetric, and $\mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P}$, so $\mathbf{P}$ is an orthogonal projection matrix; it maps (v_1, v_2) to $(v_1, 0)$.

$\mathbf{Q} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$ is idempotent:

$$\mathbf{Q}^2 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 & 0 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} = \mathbf{Q},$$

but $\mathbf{Q}^\top \neq \mathbf{Q}$, so $\mathbf{Q}$ is an oblique projection, not an orthogonal projection matrix.

Remark 0.18 (What “projection matrix” means in these notes). Some texts call any idempotent matrix a projection matrix, so that both $\mathbf{P}$ and $\mathbf{Q}$ in Example 0.45 would count as one. Regression texts often say “projection matrix” when they mean an orthogonal one. In these notes, “projection matrix” always means an orthogonal projection matrix in the sense of Definition 0.46, such as $\mathbf{P}$ in Example 0.45, and never an oblique projection (Definition 0.47) such as $\mathbf{Q}$.

Theorem 0.34 (Complement of a projection matrix). *If $\mathbf{P}$ is a $p \times p$ orthogonal projection matrix (Definition 0.46), then $\mathbf{I}_p - \mathbf{P}$ is also an orthogonal projection matrix.*

Proof

Proof. We verify symmetry and idempotency.

Symmetry:

$$(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P})^\top = \mathbf{I}^\top - \mathbf{P}^\top = \mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P}$$

Idempotency:

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P})^2 &= (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P})(\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P}) \\ &= \mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P} - \mathbf{P} + \mathbf{P}^2 \\ &= \mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P} - \mathbf{P} + \mathbf{P} \\ &= \mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P} \end{aligned}$$

□

Theorem 0.35 (Projection matrices produce orthogonal decompositions). *If $\mathbf{P}$ is a $p \times p$ orthogonal projection matrix (Definition 0.46) and $\tilde{v}$ is any vector of length p , then the two components of the decomposition*

$$\tilde{v} = \underbrace{\mathbf{P}\tilde{v}}_{\text{projected}} + \underbrace{(\mathbf{I}_p - \mathbf{P})\tilde{v}}_{\text{residual}}$$

are orthogonal:

$$\mathbf{P}\tilde{v} \perp (\mathbf{I}_p - \mathbf{P})\tilde{v}$$

i Proof

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{P}\tilde{v})^\top (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P})\tilde{v} &= \tilde{v}^\top \mathbf{P}^\top (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P})\tilde{v} \\ &= \tilde{v}^\top \mathbf{P} (\mathbf{I} - \mathbf{P})\tilde{v} \\ &= \tilde{v}^\top (\mathbf{P} - \mathbf{P}^2)\tilde{v} \\ &= \tilde{v}^\top (\mathbf{P} - \mathbf{P})\tilde{v} \\ &= \tilde{v}^\top \mathbf{0} \tilde{v} \\ &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

where the second line uses symmetry ($\mathbf{P}^\top = \mathbf{P}$) and the fourth line uses idempotency ($\mathbf{P}^2 = \mathbf{P}$). $\square$

Definition 0.48 (Orthogonal matrix). A $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{Q}$ is **orthogonal** if

$$\underbrace{\mathbf{Q}^\top}_{p \times p} \underbrace{\mathbf{Q}}_{p \times p} = \mathbf{I}_p$$

Example 0.46 (A rotation matrix). The matrix

$$\mathbf{Q} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.6 & -0.8 \\ 0.8 & 0.6 \end{bmatrix}$$

rotates each vector in the plane counterclockwise by the angle θ with $\cos \theta = 0.6$ and $\sin \theta = 0.8$ (about 53 degrees) (Banerjee and Roy 2014, chap. 8, Example 8.1, p. 207). It is orthogonal:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q} &= \begin{bmatrix} 0.6 & 0.8 \\ -0.8 & 0.6 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0.6 & -0.8 \\ 0.8 & 0.6 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 0.36 + 0.64 & -0.48 + 0.48 \\ -0.48 + 0.48 & 0.64 + 0.36 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \end{aligned}$$

Remark 0.19 (The columns of an orthogonal matrix are orthonormal). Entry (i, j) of $\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q}$ is the dot product of column i and column j of $\mathbf{Q}$, so $\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{I}_p$ says that the columns of $\mathbf{Q}$ are orthonormal (Definition 0.13). For a square matrix, $\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{I}_p$ also implies $\mathbf{Q}\mathbf{Q}^\top = \mathbf{I}_p$, so $\mathbf{Q}^{-1} = \mathbf{Q}^\top$ (Definition 0.43) (Banerjee and Roy 2014, chap. 8, Theorem 8.1 and Definition 8.1, p. 209).

For example, the columns of $\mathbf{Q}$ in Example 0.46 are $(0.6, 0.8)$ and $(-0.8, 0.6)$. The diagonal entries $0.36 + 0.64 = 1$ of $\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q}$ are their squared norms, and the off-diagonal entries $-0.48 + 0.48 = 0$ are their dot product. Multiplying in the other order also gives $\mathbf{I}_2$:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{Q}^\top &= \begin{bmatrix} 0.6 & -0.8 \\ 0.8 & 0.6 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0.6 & 0.8 \\ -0.8 & 0.6 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 0.36 + 0.64 & 0.48 - 0.48 \\ 0.48 - 0.48 & 0.64 + 0.36 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \end{aligned}$$

So $\mathbf{Q}^{-1} = \mathbf{Q}^\top$.

Theorem 0.36 (Orthogonal matrices preserve length). *If $\mathbf{Q}$ is a $p \times p$ orthogonal matrix (Definition 0.48) and $\tilde{x}$ is a vector of length p , then*

$$\|\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x}\| = \|\tilde{x}\|$$

Proof

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} \|\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x}\|^2 &= (\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x}) \cdot (\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x}) && \text{(definition of the Euclidean norm)} \\ &= (\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x})^\top (\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x}) && \text{(dot product as a matrix product)} \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{Q}^\top (\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x}) && \text{(transpose of a product)} \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top (\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q}) \tilde{x} && \text{(regroup; matrix multiplication is associative)} \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{I}_p \tilde{x} && \text{(definition of an orthogonal matrix)} \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top \tilde{x} && \text{(identity matrix)} \\ &= \|\tilde{x}\|^2 && \text{(definition of the Euclidean norm)} \end{aligned}$$

Both norms are nonnegative square roots, so equal squares give $\|\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x}\| = \|\tilde{x}\|$. The second step is Example 0.7, the third is Theorem 0.10, and the fourth is Theorem 0.7. $\square$

Example 0.47 (Rotating a vector keeps its length). With $\mathbf{Q}$ from Example 0.46 and $\tilde{x} = (3, 4)$ from Example 0.4:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbf{Q}\tilde{x} &= \begin{bmatrix} 0.6 \cdot 3 - 0.8 \cdot 4 \\ 0.8 \cdot 3 + 0.6 \cdot 4 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix-vector multiplication)} \\
 &= \begin{bmatrix} 1.8 - 3.2 \\ 2.4 + 2.4 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
 &= \begin{bmatrix} -1.4 \\ 4.8 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
 \|\mathbf{Q}\tilde{x}\| &= \sqrt{(-1.4)^2 + 4.8^2} && \text{(definition of the norm)} \\
 &= \sqrt{1.96 + 23.04} && \text{(square)} \\
 &= \sqrt{25} && \text{(add)} \\
 &= 5 && \text{(take the square root)}
 \end{aligned}$$

which is $\|\tilde{x}\| = 5$.

Quadratic Forms

Definition 0.49 (Quadratic form). A **quadratic form** is a mathematical expression of the structure

$$\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x}$$

where $\tilde{x}$ is a $p \times 1$ vector and $\mathbf{S}$ is a $p \times p$ matrix.

Remark 0.20 (Quadratic forms in statistics). A quadratic form extends the scalar expression cx^2 to vectors: with $p = 1$ and $\mathbf{S} = [c]$, $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x} = cx^2$. With $p = 2$,

$$\tilde{x}^\top \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \tilde{x} = x_1^2 + 2x_1x_2 + 3x_2^2,$$

which is $1 + 4 + 12 = 17$ at $\tilde{x} = (1, 2)$.

Quadratic forms occur often in statistics:

- The residual sum of squares in linear regression (see [Vector Calculus](#)) is a quadratic form.
- The variance of a linear combination of estimates (see [Inference about Gaussian Linear Regression Models](#)) is a quadratic form: $\text{Var}\left(\tilde{x}^\top \hat{\beta}\right) = \tilde{x}^\top \text{Var}\left(\hat{\beta}\right) \tilde{x}$.

Definition 0.50 (Symmetric part of a square matrix). The **symmetric part** of a $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{S}$ is

$$\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{S} + \mathbf{S}^\top)$$

Example 0.48 (The symmetric part of a 2×2 matrix). For $\mathbf{S} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$, the symmetric part is

$$\frac{1}{2} \left(\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} + \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \right) = \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ 2 & 6 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix},$$

which is symmetric.

Theorem 0.37 (A quadratic form depends only on the symmetric part). *If $\mathbf{S}$ is a $p \times p$ matrix and $\tilde{x}$ is a vector of length p , then*

$$\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x} = \tilde{x}^\top \left(\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{S} + \mathbf{S}^\top) \right) \tilde{x}.$$

So the value of a quadratic form depends only on the symmetric part (Definition 0.50) of $\mathbf{S}$.

i Proof

Proof. The quadratic form $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x}$ is a 1×1 matrix, so it equals its own transpose:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x} &= (\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x})^\top && \text{(a } 1 \times 1 \text{ matrix is symmetric)} \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S}^\top (\tilde{x}^\top)^\top && \text{(transpose of a product, twice)} \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S}^\top \tilde{x} && \text{(transposing twice changes nothing)} \end{aligned}$$

Averaging the two expressions for $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x}$:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x} &= \frac{1}{2}(\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x} + \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S}^\top \tilde{x}) && \text{(average of two equal numbers)} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \tilde{x}^\top (\mathbf{S} + \mathbf{S}^\top) \tilde{x} && \text{(distributive law)} \\ &= \tilde{x}^\top \left(\frac{1}{2}(\mathbf{S} + \mathbf{S}^\top) \right) \tilde{x} && \text{(move the scalar } \frac{1}{2} \text{ inside)} \end{aligned}$$

The distributive step is Theorem 0.8, and the transpose step is Theorem 0.10. □

Example 0.49 (Replacing a matrix by its symmetric part). With $\mathbf{S} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$ from Example 0.48 and $\tilde{x} = (1, 1)$:

$$\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{S} \tilde{x} = 1 + 2 + 0 + 3 = 6 \quad \tilde{x}^\top \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \tilde{x} = 1 + 1 + 1 + 3 = 6$$

Both quadratic forms equal the sum of their matrix's entries, because every entry of $\tilde{x}$ is 1.

Trace and Matrix Inner Product

Definition 0.51 (Trace). The **trace** of a $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{M}$ is the sum of its diagonal entries:

$$\text{tr}(\mathbf{M}) \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \sum_{i=1}^p M_{ii}$$

Example 0.50 (The trace of a 2×2 matrix).

$$\text{tr}\left(\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}\right) = 1 + 4 = 5$$

Theorem 0.38 (The trace of a product does not depend on the order). *For an $m \times n$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ and an $n \times m$ matrix $\mathbf{B}$:*

$$\text{tr}\left(\underbrace{\mathbf{AB}}_{m \times m}\right) = \text{tr}\left(\underbrace{\mathbf{BA}}_{n \times n}\right)$$

i Proof

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{tr}(\mathbf{AB}) &= \sum_{i=1}^m (\mathbf{AB})_{ii} && \text{(definition of the trace)} \\
 &= \sum_{i=1}^m \sum_{s=1}^n a_{is} b_{si} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
 &= \sum_{s=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^m a_{is} b_{si} && \text{(swap the order of two finite sums)} \\
 &= \sum_{s=1}^n \sum_{i=1}^m b_{si} a_{is} && \text{(multiplication of numbers is commutative)} \\
 &= \sum_{s=1}^n (\mathbf{BA})_{ss} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
 &= \text{tr}(\mathbf{BA}) && \text{(definition of the trace)}
 \end{aligned}$$

□

Example 0.51 (Traces of the two products of a 2×3 and a 3×2 matrix). Let

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

The products are

$$\mathbf{AB} = \begin{bmatrix} 5 & 2 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{BA} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 0 \\ 2 & 5 & 3 \\ 0 & 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

The trace needs only the diagonal entries. For $\mathbf{AB}$, which is 2×2 :

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{tr}(\mathbf{AB}) &= (\mathbf{AB})_{11} + (\mathbf{AB})_{22} && \text{(definition of the trace)} \\
 &= (1 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 2 + 0 \cdot 0) + (0 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot 1) && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
 &= (1 + 4 + 0) + (0 + 1 + 3) && \text{(multiply)} \\
 &= 5 + 4 && \text{(add within each entry)} \\
 &= 9 && \text{(add)}
 \end{aligned}$$

For $\mathbf{BA}$, which is 3×3 :

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{tr}(\mathbf{BA}) &= (\mathbf{BA})_{11} + (\mathbf{BA})_{22} + (\mathbf{BA})_{33} && \text{(definition of the trace)} \\
&= (1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0) + (2 \cdot 2 + 1 \cdot 1) + (0 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 3) && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
&= (1 + 0) + (4 + 1) + (0 + 3) && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 1 + 5 + 3 && \text{(add within each entry)} \\
&= 9 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

The products have different sizes, but their traces agree.

Remark 0.21 (Moving a factor of a triple product). Let $\mathbf{A}$ be $m \times n$, $\mathbf{B}$ be $n \times k$, and $\mathbf{C}$ be $k \times m$, so that $\mathbf{AB}$ is $m \times k$ and $\mathbf{ABC}$ is square. Applying Theorem 0.38 to the $m \times k$ matrix $\mathbf{AB}$ and the $k \times m$ matrix $\mathbf{C}$ moves the last factor of the triple product to the front (Banerjee and Roy 2014, chap. 1, Theorem 1.5 and eq. 1.17, p. 19):

$$\begin{aligned}
\text{tr}(\mathbf{ABC}) &= \text{tr}((\mathbf{AB})\mathbf{C}) && \text{(matrix multiplication is associative)} \\
&= \text{tr}(\mathbf{C}(\mathbf{AB})) && \text{(the theorem, applied to the two factors } \mathbf{AB} \text{ and } \mathbf{C}) \\
&= \text{tr}(\mathbf{CAB}) && \text{(matrix multiplication is associative)}
\end{aligned}$$

For example, let

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{C} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Then

$$\mathbf{AB} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 0 + 2 \cdot 1 \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 2 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{CA} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 0 \cdot 2 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 2 + 0 \cdot 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

so

$$(\mathbf{AB})\mathbf{C} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 \cdot 0 + 2 \cdot 1 & 3 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 0 \\ 1 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad (\mathbf{CA})\mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 1 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 0 + 2 \cdot 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 3 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

and both traces are the same: $\text{tr}(\mathbf{ABC}) = 2 + 1 = 3$ and $\text{tr}(\mathbf{CAB}) = 1 + 2 = 3$.

Definition 0.52 (Matrix inner product). The **inner product** of two $n \times p$ matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ is

$$\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \text{tr} \left(\underbrace{\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{B}}_{p \times p} \right)$$

Banerjee and Roy (2014, chap. 15, eq. 15.7, p. 491) defines the same inner product on $n \times p$ matrices with the trace.

Theorem 0.39 (The matrix inner product multiplies matching entries). *For two $n \times p$ matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$:*

$$\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle = \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^p a_{ij} b_{ij}$$

i Proof

Proof.

$$\begin{aligned} \langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle &= \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{B}) && \text{(definition of the inner product)} \\ &= \sum_{j=1}^p (\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{B})_{jj} && \text{(definition of the trace)} \\ &= \sum_{j=1}^p \sum_{i=1}^n (\mathbf{A}^\top)_{ji} b_{ij} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\ &= \sum_{j=1}^p \sum_{i=1}^n a_{ij} b_{ij} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^p a_{ij} b_{ij} && \text{(swap the order of two finite sums)} \end{aligned}$$

□

Example 0.52 (The inner product of two 2×2 matrices). Let

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

From Definition 0.52:

$$\begin{aligned}
\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle &= \text{tr}(\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{B}) && \text{(definition of the inner product)} \\
&= \text{tr} \left(\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}^\top \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \right) && \text{(substitute)} \\
&= \text{tr} \left(\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \right) && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\
&= \text{tr} \left(\begin{bmatrix} -3 & 7 \\ -4 & 10 \end{bmatrix} \right) && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= -3 + 10 && \text{(definition of the trace)} \\
&= 7 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

From Theorem 0.39:

$$\begin{aligned}
\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle &= 1 \cdot 0 + 2 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot (-1) + 4 \cdot 2 && \text{(multiply matching entries and add)} \\
&= 0 + 2 - 3 + 8 && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 7 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

Remark 0.22 (The matrix inner product as a dot product). Theorem 0.39 says that the matrix inner product is the dot product (Definition 0.5) of the two matrices' entries, each listed as one vector of length np , with both matrices' entries listed in the same order. For example, listing the entries of $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ in Example 0.52 row by row gives $(1, 2, 3, 4)$ and $(0, 1, -1, 2)$, and $(1, 2, 3, 4) \cdot (0, 1, -1, 2) = 7 = \langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{B} \rangle$.

Definition 0.53 (Frobenius norm). The **Frobenius norm** of an $n \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is

$$\|\mathbf{A}\|_F \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \sqrt{\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{A} \rangle}$$

where $\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle$ is the matrix inner product (Definition 0.52).

Example 0.53 (The Frobenius norm of a 2×2 matrix). For $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 3 & 4 \end{bmatrix}$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\|\mathbf{A}\|_F &= \sqrt{\langle \mathbf{A}, \mathbf{A} \rangle} && \text{(definition of the Frobenius norm)} \\
&= \sqrt{1 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 2 + 3 \cdot 3 + 4 \cdot 4} && \text{(sum of products of matching entries)} \\
&= \sqrt{1 + 4 + 9 + 16} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \sqrt{30} && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

The second step is Theorem 0.39.

Remark 0.23 (The Frobenius norm is the Euclidean norm of the entries). By Theorem 0.39, $\|\mathbf{A}\|_F^2 = \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^p a_{ij}^2$, a sum of squares, so the square root is always defined. $\|\mathbf{A}\|_F$ is the Euclidean norm (Definition 0.11) of the entries of $\mathbf{A}$, listed as one vector of length np (Banerjee and Roy 2014, chap. 15, Definition 15.4, p. 492).

For example, listing the entries of $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.53 row by row gives the vector $(1, 2, 3, 4)$ of length $2 \cdot 2 = 4$, and $\|(1, 2, 3, 4)\| = \sqrt{1 + 4 + 9 + 16} = \sqrt{30} = \|\mathbf{A}\|_F$.

Matrix Decompositions

Definition 0.54 (Eigenvalue and eigenvector). Let $\mathbf{A}$ be a $p \times p$ matrix. A real number λ is an **eigenvalue** of $\mathbf{A}$ if some real vector $\tilde{v} \neq \tilde{0}$ of length p satisfies

$$\underset{p \times p}{\mathbf{A}} \underset{p \times 1}{\tilde{v}} = \lambda \underset{p \times 1}{\tilde{v}}$$

Any such $\tilde{v}$ is an **eigenvector** of $\mathbf{A}$ for λ .

Example 0.54 (Eigenvectors of a 2×2 matrix). Let $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$.

$(1, 1)$ is an eigenvector for the eigenvalue 3:

$$\begin{aligned} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} &= \begin{bmatrix} 2+1 \\ 1+2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix-vector multiplication)} \\ &= 3 \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(factor out 3)} \end{aligned}$$

$(1, -1)$ is an eigenvector for the eigenvalue 1:

$$\begin{aligned} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} &= \begin{bmatrix} 2-1 \\ 1-2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix-vector multiplication)} \\ &= 1 \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(factor out 1)} \end{aligned}$$

Remark 0.24 (Multiples of an eigenvector). Multiplying by $\mathbf{A}$ rescales an eigenvector by λ and does not change the line it lies on. Any nonzero multiple $c\tilde{v}$ of an eigenvector is also an eigenvector for the same λ :

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{A}(c\tilde{v}) &= c\mathbf{A}\tilde{v} && \text{(move the scalar } c \text{ to the front)} \\
&= c\lambda\tilde{v} && (\tilde{v} \text{ is an eigenvector for } \lambda) \\
&= \lambda(c\tilde{v}) && \text{(multiplication of numbers is commutative)}
\end{aligned}$$

For example, in Example 0.54, $2(1, 1) = (2, 2)$ is also an eigenvector for the eigenvalue 3:

$$\begin{aligned}
\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} &= \begin{bmatrix} 2 \cdot 2 + 1 \cdot 2 \\ 1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix-vector multiplication)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 4 + 2 \\ 2 + 4 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 6 \\ 6 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= 3 \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(factor out 3)}
\end{aligned}$$

Example 0.55 (A vector that is not an eigenvector). For the same $\mathbf{A}$, $(1, 0)$ is not an eigenvector:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix},$$

and no number λ gives $(2, 1) = \lambda(1, 0)$, because the second entries would need $1 = \lambda \cdot 0$.

Remark 0.25 (Real and complex eigenvalues). These notes take λ and $\tilde{v}$ to be real. Banerjee and Roy (2014, chap. 11, Definition 11.1, pp. 312-313) also allows complex eigenvalues and eigenvectors, because some real matrices, such as a rotation by 90 degrees, have no real eigenvalues (Banerjee and Roy 2014, chap. 11, Example 11.2, p. 312).

For example, $\mathbf{R} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$ rotates each vector in the plane counterclockwise by 90 degrees: $\mathbf{R}(v_1, v_2) = (-v_2, v_1)$. Suppose $\mathbf{R}\tilde{v} = \lambda\tilde{v}$ for a real number λ . Matching entries gives $-v_2 = \lambda v_1$ and $v_1 = \lambda v_2$. Substituting the second equation into the first gives $-v_2 = \lambda^2 v_2$, so $(1 + \lambda^2)v_2 = 0$. Since $1 + \lambda^2 > 0$, $v_2 = 0$, and then $v_1 = \lambda v_2 = 0$. So the only solution is $\tilde{v} = \tilde{0}$, and $\mathbf{R}$ has no real eigenvalue.

Theorem 0.40 (Spectral theorem for symmetric matrices). *If $\mathbf{A}$ is a $p \times p$ symmetric matrix (Definition 0.41) with real entries, then there are a $p \times p$ orthogonal matrix $\mathbf{Q}$ (Definition 0.48) and a $p \times p$ diagonal matrix (Definition 0.42) with real diagonal entries $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_p$ such that*

$$\underbrace{\mathbf{A}}_{p \times p} = \underbrace{\mathbf{Q}}_{p \times p} \underbrace{\underbrace{\mathbf{Q}^\top}_{p \times p}}_{p \times p}$$

Each λ_i is an eigenvalue of $\mathbf{A}$ (Definition 0.54), and column i of $\mathbf{Q}$ is an eigenvector of $\mathbf{A}$ for λ_i .

Remark 0.26 (An equivalent form of the spectral theorem). The proof, by induction on p , is outside the scope of these notes; see Banerjee and Roy (2014, chap. 11, Theorem 11.27, p. 349), which states the result in the equivalent form $\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{D}$. The two forms are equivalent because $\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top = \mathbf{I}_p$ (Remark 0.19). Multiplying $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{D}$ by $\mathbf{Q}^\top$ on the left and by $\mathbf{Q}$ on the right gives

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{Q} &= \mathbf{Q}^\top (\mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top) \mathbf{Q} && \text{(substitute)} \\ &= (\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q}) (\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q}) && \text{(regroup; matrix multiplication is associative)} \\ &= \mathbf{I}_p \mathbf{I}_p && (\mathbf{Q} \text{ is orthogonal}) \\ &= \mathbf{D} && \text{(multiplying by } \mathbf{I}_p \text{ changes nothing)} \end{aligned}$$

Multiplying $\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{D}$ by $\mathbf{Q}$ on the left and by $\mathbf{Q}^\top$ on the right gives back the first form:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top &= \mathbf{Q} (\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{Q}) \mathbf{Q}^\top && \text{(substitute)} \\ &= (\mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top) \mathbf{A} (\mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top) && \text{(regroup; matrix multiplication is associative)} \\ &= \mathbf{I}_p \mathbf{A} \mathbf{I}_p && (\mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top = \mathbf{I}_p) \\ &= \mathbf{A} && \text{(multiplying by } \mathbf{I}_p \text{ changes nothing)} \end{aligned}$$

For example, let $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{Q} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$, which is symmetric, so $\mathbf{Q}^\top = \mathbf{Q}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{A} \mathbf{Q} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(substitute)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(move the scalars to the front)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply the scalars)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 2 + 1 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 2 \\ 1 \cdot 2 + (-1) \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot 2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication, first two matrices)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2+1 & 1+2 \\ 2-1 & 1-2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 3 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 3 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot 1 & 3 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot (-1) \\ 1 \cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot (-1) \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 3+3 & 3-3 \\ 1-1 & 1+1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 6 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply by } \frac{1}{2} \text{)}
\end{aligned}$$

a diagonal matrix with the eigenvalues 3 and 1 of $\mathbf{A}$ from Example 0.54 on its diagonal.

Definition 0.55 (Eigendecomposition). Let $\mathbf{A}$ be a $p \times p$ symmetric matrix with real entries. An **eigendecomposition**, or **spectral decomposition**, of $\mathbf{A}$ is a factorization

$$\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top$$

with $\mathbf{Q}$ a $p \times p$ orthogonal matrix (Definition 0.48) and a $p \times p$ diagonal matrix (Definition 0.42). Theorem 0.40 says that every such $\mathbf{A}$ has one.

Example 0.56 (An eigendecomposition of a 2×2 symmetric matrix). For $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$, Example 0.54 found the eigenvectors $(1, 1)$ for 3 and $(1, -1)$ for 1. They are orthogonal (Definition 0.10):

$$\begin{aligned}
(1, 1) \cdot (1, -1) &= 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot (-1) && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\
&= 1 - 1 && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 0 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

Each has norm $\sqrt{1^2 + 1^2} = \sqrt{2}$ (Definition 0.11), so dividing each by $\sqrt{2}$ gives two orthonormal eigenvectors (Definition 0.13). Put them in the columns of $\mathbf{Q}$, and the matching eigenvalues on the diagonal of :

$$\mathbf{Q} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \end{bmatrix}$$

This $\mathbf{Q}$ is symmetric, so $\mathbf{Q}^\top = \mathbf{Q}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{Q}\mathbf{Q}^\top &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \end{bmatrix} && \text{(substitute)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(move the scalars to the front)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply the scalars)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot (-1) \\ 1 \cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot (-1) + (-1) \cdot (-1) \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication, first two matrices)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot (-1) \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 2 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot (-1) + 2 \cdot (-1) \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -2 \\ 2 & -2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -2 \\ 2 & -2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply by } \frac{1}{2} \text{)}
\end{aligned}$$

which is $\mathbf{A}$.

Remark 0.27 (An eigendecomposition is not unique). A symmetric matrix can have more than one eigendecomposition. Reordering the eigenvalues on the diagonal of , and the

columns of $\mathbf{Q}$ with them, gives another one, and so does multiplying a column of $\mathbf{Q}$ by -1 .

For example, take $\mathbf{A}$ from Example 0.56. Swapping the two eigenvalues and the two columns gives

$$\mathbf{Q}_1 = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{Q}_1^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$$

and multiplying the second column of $\mathbf{Q}$ by -1 gives

$$\mathbf{Q}_2 = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{Q}_2^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

The columns of $\mathbf{Q}_1$ and $\mathbf{Q}_2$ are the columns of $\mathbf{Q}$, reordered or multiplied by -1 , so they are still orthonormal, and $\mathbf{Q}_1$ and $\mathbf{Q}_2$ are orthogonal. Both products give back $\mathbf{A}$:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{Q}_1 \mathbf{Q}_1^\top &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right)^\top && \text{(substitute)} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(move the scalars to the front)} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply the scalars)} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 3 \\ -1 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 0 & -1 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication, first two matrices)} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 + 0 & 0 + 3 \\ -1 + 0 & 0 + 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 3 \\ -1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot 1 & 1 \cdot (-1) + 3 \cdot 1 \\ -1 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot 1 & -1 \cdot (-1) + 3 \cdot 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 + 3 & -1 + 3 \\ -1 + 3 & 1 + 3 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\ &= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 2 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply by } \frac{1}{2} \text{)} \end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{Q}_{22}\mathbf{Q}_2^\top &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \right)^\top && \text{(substitute)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(move the scalars to the front)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply the scalars)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \cdot 3 + (-1) \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 0 + (-1) \cdot 1 \\ 1 \cdot 3 + 1 \cdot 0 & 1 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication, first two matrices)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 3 + 0 & 0 - 1 \\ 3 + 0 & 0 + 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & -1 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 3 \cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot (-1) & 3 \cdot 1 + (-1) \cdot 1 \\ 3 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot (-1) & 3 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 3 + 1 & 3 - 1 \\ 3 - 1 & 3 + 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 2 \\ 2 & 4 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply by } \frac{1}{2} \text{)}
\end{aligned}$$

Theorem 0.41 (Singular value decomposition). *Let $\mathbf{A}$ be an $n \times p$ matrix with real entries and $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = r$ (Definition 0.26). Then there are an $n \times n$ orthogonal matrix $\mathbf{U}$, a $p \times p$ orthogonal matrix $\mathbf{V}$ (Definition 0.48), and numbers $\sigma_1 \geq \sigma_2 \geq \dots \geq \sigma_r > 0$ such that*

$$\underbrace{\mathbf{A}}_{n \times p} = \underbrace{\mathbf{U}}_{n \times n} \underbrace{\mathbf{D}}_{n \times p} \underbrace{\mathbf{V}^\top}_{p \times p}$$

where $\mathbf{D}$ has entries $d_{ii} = \sigma_i$ for $i = 1, \dots, r$ and every other entry 0.

Remark 0.28 (The SVD applies to every real matrix). The proof is outside the scope of these notes; see Banerjee and Roy (2014, chap. 12, Theorem 12.1, p. 373). Unlike the spectral theorem (Theorem 0.40), Theorem 0.41 applies to every real matrix, including

one that is not square or not symmetric.

For example, the 1×2 matrix $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is not square, so Theorem 0.40 does not apply to it. It has rank 1, and Theorem 0.41 holds with $\mathbf{U} = [1]$, $\mathbf{D} = \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} & 0 \end{bmatrix}$, and $\mathbf{V}$ the orthogonal matrix $\mathbf{Q}$ from Example 0.56, which is symmetric, so $\mathbf{V}^\top = \mathbf{V}$:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbf{UDV}^\top &= [1] \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} & 0 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(substitute)} \\
 &= [\sqrt{2} \quad 0] \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiplying by the } 1 \times 1 \text{ identity changes nothing)} \\
 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} [\sqrt{2} \quad 0] \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(move the scalar to the front)} \\
 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} [\sqrt{2} \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 1 \quad \sqrt{2} \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot (-1)] && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} [\sqrt{2} + 0 \quad \sqrt{2} + 0] && \text{(multiply)} \\
 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} [\sqrt{2} \quad \sqrt{2}] && \text{(add)} \\
 &= [1 \quad 1] && \text{(divide by } \sqrt{2})
 \end{aligned}$$

$\mathbf{U}$ is orthogonal because $\mathbf{U}^\top \mathbf{U} = [1] = \mathbf{I}_1$, and the single singular value is $\sigma_1 = \sqrt{2}$.

Definition 0.56 (Singular value decomposition and singular values). Let $\mathbf{A}$ be an $n \times p$ matrix with real entries and $\text{rank}(\mathbf{A}) = r$. A **singular value decomposition** (SVD) of $\mathbf{A}$ is a factorization $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{UDV}^\top$ with $\mathbf{U}$, $\mathbf{D}$ and $\mathbf{V}$ as in Theorem 0.41. The numbers $\sigma_1 \geq \dots \geq \sigma_r > 0$ on the diagonal of $\mathbf{D}$ are the **singular values** of $\mathbf{A}$.

Example 0.57 (An SVD of a 3×2 matrix). Let

$$\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{U} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{D} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{V} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

$\mathbf{V}$ is the orthogonal matrix $\mathbf{Q}$ from Example 0.56. $\mathbf{U}$ is orthogonal too. Entry (i, j) of $\mathbf{U}^\top \mathbf{U}$ is the dot product of columns i and j of $\mathbf{U}$, and those columns are $\tilde{u}_1 = (\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}, 0, \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}})$, $\tilde{u}_2 = (0, 1, 0)$ and $\tilde{u}_3 = (\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}, 0, -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}})$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{u}_1 \cdot \tilde{u}_1 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + 0 \cdot 0 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} + 0 + \frac{1}{2} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 1 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{u}_2 \cdot \tilde{u}_2 &= 0 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\
&= 0 + 1 + 0 && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 1 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{u}_3 \cdot \tilde{u}_3 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + 0 \cdot 0 + \left(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\right) \cdot \left(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\right) && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} + 0 + \frac{1}{2} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 1 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{u}_1 \cdot \tilde{u}_2 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot 1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\
&= 0 + 0 + 0 && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 0 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{u}_1 \cdot \tilde{u}_3 &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + 0 \cdot 0 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \left(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\right) && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} + 0 - \frac{1}{2} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 0 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{u}_2 \cdot \tilde{u}_3 &= 0 \cdot \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} + 1 \cdot 0 + 0 \cdot \left(-\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}\right) && \text{(definition of the dot product)} \\
&= 0 + 0 + 0 && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= 0 && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

The dot product is symmetric, so these six values fill in all nine entries, and $\mathbf{U}^\top \mathbf{U} = \mathbf{I}_3$. $\mathbf{V}$ is symmetric, so $\mathbf{V}^\top = \mathbf{V}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{D}\mathbf{V}^\top &= \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(substitute)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(move the scalar to the front)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 2 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 1 & 2 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot (-1) \\ 0 \cdot 1 + \sqrt{2} \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 1 + \sqrt{2} \cdot (-1) \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot (-1) \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 2 + 0 & 2 + 0 \\ 0 + \sqrt{2} & 0 - \sqrt{2} \\ 0 + 0 & 0 + 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 2 \\ \sqrt{2} & -\sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} & \sqrt{2} \\ 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(divide by } \sqrt{2})
\end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{U}\mathbf{D}\mathbf{V}^\top &= \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} \sqrt{2} & \sqrt{2} \\ 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(substitute)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \sqrt{2} + 0 \cdot 1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \sqrt{2} + 0 \cdot (-1) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 \\ 0 \cdot \sqrt{2} + 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 & 0 \cdot \sqrt{2} + 1 \cdot (-1) + 0 \cdot 0 \\ \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \sqrt{2} + 0 \cdot 1 - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot \sqrt{2} + 0 \cdot (-1) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 1 + 0 + 0 & 1 + 0 + 0 \\ 0 + 1 + 0 & 0 - 1 + 0 \\ 1 + 0 - 0 & 1 + 0 - 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

which is $\mathbf{A}$. $\mathbf{A}$ has rank 2, because its two columns are linearly independent, and its singular values are $\sigma_1 = 2$ and $\sigma_2 = \sqrt{2}$.

Remark 0.29 (An SVD is not unique). An SVD is not unique (Banerjee and Roy 2014, chap. 12, Examples 12.2 and 12.3, p. 378). For any $i \leq r$, multiplying column i of both $\mathbf{U}$ and $\mathbf{V}$ by -1 gives another one. The singular values do not depend on which SVD is chosen (Banerjee and Roy 2014, chap. 12, pp. 371 and 378).

For example, in Example 0.57, multiplying the first columns of $\mathbf{U}$ and $\mathbf{V}$ by -1 gives

$$\mathbf{U}_1 = \begin{bmatrix} -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \end{bmatrix} \quad \mathbf{V}_1 = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 1 \\ -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

Their columns are the columns of $\mathbf{U}$ and $\mathbf{V}$, some multiplied by -1 , so they are still orthonormal. With the same $\mathbf{D}$:

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{D}\mathbf{V}_1^\top &= \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 1 \\ -1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \right)^\top && \text{(substitute)} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & -1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & -1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(move the scalar to the front)} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 2 \cdot (-1) + 0 \cdot 1 & 2 \cdot (-1) + 0 \cdot (-1) \\ 0 \cdot (-1) + \sqrt{2} \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot (-1) + \sqrt{2} \cdot (-1) \\ 0 \cdot (-1) + 0 \cdot 1 & 0 \cdot (-1) + 0 \cdot (-1) \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} -2 + 0 & -2 + 0 \\ 0 + \sqrt{2} & 0 - \sqrt{2} \\ 0 + 0 & 0 + 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\ &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} -2 & -2 \\ \sqrt{2} & -\sqrt{2} \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\ &= \begin{bmatrix} -\sqrt{2} & -\sqrt{2} \\ 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(divide by } \sqrt{2}) \end{aligned}$$

and

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{U}_1 \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}_1^\top &= \begin{bmatrix} -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 & \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} & 0 & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} -\sqrt{2} & -\sqrt{2} \\ 1 & -1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(substitute)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot (-\sqrt{2}) + 0 \cdot 1 + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot (-\sqrt{2}) + 0 \cdot (-1) + \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 \\ 0 \cdot (-\sqrt{2}) + 1 \cdot 1 + 0 \cdot 0 & 0 \cdot (-\sqrt{2}) + 1 \cdot (-1) + 0 \cdot 0 \\ -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot (-\sqrt{2}) + 0 \cdot 1 - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 & -\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot (-\sqrt{2}) + 0 \cdot (-1) - \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \cdot 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 1 + 0 + 0 & 1 + 0 + 0 \\ 0 + 1 + 0 & 0 - 1 + 0 \\ 1 + 0 - 0 & 1 + 0 - 0 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

which is $\mathbf{A}$ again. Both SVDs have the singular values $\sigma_1 = 2$ and $\sigma_2 = \sqrt{2}$.

Remark 0.30 (Counting zero singular values). Some texts, and R's `svd()`, also count $\min(n, p) - r$ singular values equal to 0, so that every $n \times p$ matrix has $\min(n, p)$ singular values.

For example, $\mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$ has rank $r = 1$. Taking $\mathbf{U} = \mathbf{V} = \mathbf{I}_2$ and $\mathbf{D} = \mathbf{B}$ gives an SVD $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{I}_2 \mathbf{B} \mathbf{I}_2^\top$, so by Definition 0.56, $\mathbf{B}$ has one singular value, $\sigma_1 = 3$. R's `svd()` reports $\min(2, 2) = 2$ singular values for $\mathbf{B}$: 3 and 0.

Theorem 0.42 (An SVD gives an eigendecomposition of $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$). *Let $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{U} \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top$ be a singular value decomposition (Definition 0.56) of an $n \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ with singular values $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r$. Then $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$ is symmetric (Definition 0.41), and*

$$\underbrace{\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}}_{p \times p} = \underbrace{\mathbf{V}}_{p \times p} \underbrace{\mathbf{D}^\top \mathbf{D}}_{p \times p} \underbrace{\mathbf{V}^\top}_{p \times p}$$

where $\stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \mathbf{D}^\top \mathbf{D}$ is the $p \times p$ diagonal matrix whose i -th diagonal entry λ_i is σ_i^2 for $i \leq r$ and 0 for $i > r$. So $\mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^\top$ is an eigendecomposition (Definition 0.55) of $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$: column i of $\mathbf{V}$ is an eigenvector of $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$ for the eigenvalue λ_i .

i Proof

Proof. Symmetry.

$$\begin{aligned} (\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A})^\top &= \mathbf{A}^\top (\mathbf{A}^\top)^\top && \text{(transpose of a product)} \\ &= \mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} && \text{(transposing twice changes nothing)} \end{aligned}$$

The first step is Theorem 0.10, and the second follows from Definition 0.16, which swaps rows and columns, so swapping them again restores $\mathbf{A}$.

The factorization.

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} &= (\mathbf{U} \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top)^\top \mathbf{U} \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top && \text{(substitute the SVD)} \\ &= (\mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top)^\top \mathbf{U}^\top \mathbf{U} \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top && \text{(transpose of the product of } \mathbf{U} \text{ and } \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top) \\ &= (\mathbf{V}^\top)^\top \mathbf{D}^\top \mathbf{U}^\top \mathbf{U} \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top && \text{(transpose of the product of } \mathbf{D} \text{ and } \mathbf{V}^\top) \\ &= \mathbf{V} \mathbf{D}^\top \mathbf{U}^\top \mathbf{U} \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top && \text{(transposing twice changes nothing)} \\ &= \mathbf{V} \mathbf{D}^\top (\mathbf{U}^\top \mathbf{U}) \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top && \text{(regroup; matrix multiplication is associative)} \\ &= \mathbf{V} \mathbf{D}^\top \mathbf{I}_n \mathbf{D} \mathbf{V}^\top && \text{(} \mathbf{U} \text{ is orthogonal)} \\ &= \mathbf{V} (\mathbf{D}^\top \mathbf{D}) \mathbf{V}^\top && \text{(identity matrix)} \\ &= \mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^\top && \text{(definition of)} \end{aligned}$$

The entries of λ . Write λ_{ij} for entry (i, j) of λ , so $\lambda_i = \lambda_{ii}$. Only the entries d_{kk} with $k \leq r$ of $\mathbf{D}$ can be nonzero.

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda_{ij} &= \sum_{k=1}^n (\mathbf{D}^\top)_{ik} d_{kj} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\ &= \sum_{k=1}^n d_{ki} d_{kj} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \end{aligned}$$

The term for k is nonzero only if $k = i \leq r$ and $k = j$. So $\lambda_{ij} = 0$ when $i \neq j$. On the diagonal, only the term $k = i$ can be nonzero, and for $i \leq r$

$$\begin{aligned} \lambda_i &= \lambda_{ii} && \text{(notation)} \\ &= d_{ii} d_{ii} && \text{(the only term that can be nonzero)} \\ &= \sigma_i \cdot \sigma_i && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{D}) \\ &= \sigma_i^2 && \text{(notation for a square)} \end{aligned}$$

For $i > r$, every term is 0, so $\lambda_i = 0$.

The eigenvectors. Write $\tilde{v}_i$ for column i of $\mathbf{V}$, and $\tilde{e}_i$ for the indicator vector (Definition 0.9) of length p . Column i of $\mathbf{V}^\top \mathbf{V} = \mathbf{I}_p$ says $\mathbf{V}^\top \tilde{v}_i = \tilde{e}_i$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{v}_i &= \mathbf{V} \mathbf{V}^\top \tilde{v}_i && \text{(the factorization)} \\
&= \mathbf{V} \tilde{e}_i && (\mathbf{V}^\top \tilde{v}_i = \tilde{e}_i) \\
&= \mathbf{V} (\lambda_i \tilde{e}_i) && \text{(column } i \text{ of the diagonal matrix)} \\
&= \lambda_i \mathbf{V} \tilde{e}_i && \text{(move the scalar } \lambda_i \text{ to the front)} \\
&= \lambda_i \tilde{v}_i && (\mathbf{V} \tilde{e}_i \text{ is column } i \text{ of } \mathbf{V})
\end{aligned}$$

and $\tilde{v}_i \neq \tilde{0}$ because it has norm 1. □

Example 0.58 ($\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$ for the matrix of the SVD example). For $\mathbf{A}$ in Example 0.57:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A} &= \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of the transpose)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 1+1+1 & 1-1+1 \\ 1-1+1 & 1+1+1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix multiplication)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)}
\end{aligned}$$

Theorem 0.42 says its eigenvalues are $\sigma_1^2 = 4$ and $\sigma_2^2 = 2$, with the columns of $\mathbf{V}$ as eigenvectors. Checking the first column, up to its factor $\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}$:

$$\begin{aligned}
\begin{bmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} &= \begin{bmatrix} 3 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 1 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix-vector multiplication)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 3+1 \\ 1+3 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 4 \\ 4 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= 4 \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(factor out 4)}
\end{aligned}$$

and the second:

$$\begin{aligned}
\begin{bmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} &= \begin{bmatrix} 3 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot (-1) \\ 1 \cdot 1 + 3 \cdot (-1) \end{bmatrix} && \text{(definition of matrix-vector multiplication)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 3-1 \\ 1-3 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ -2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(add)} \\
&= 2 \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(factor out 2)}
\end{aligned}$$

Remark 0.31 (Building an SVD from an eigendecomposition). Theorem 0.42 matches Banerjee and Roy (2014, chap. 12, pp. 372-373), which works in the other direction: it constructs an SVD from a spectral decomposition of $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$ and sets $\sigma_i = \sqrt{\lambda_i}$. For example, in Example 0.58 the eigenvalues of $\mathbf{A}^\top \mathbf{A}$ are 4 and 2, and $\sqrt{4} = 2$ and $\sqrt{2}$ are the singular values σ_1 and σ_2 of $\mathbf{A}$ from Example 0.57.

Definite Matrices

Definition 0.57 (Positive semidefinite matrix). A $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is **positive semidefinite** if it satisfies both conditions:

- $\mathbf{A}$ is symmetric (Definition 0.41).
- Every quadratic form (Definition 0.49) in $\mathbf{A}$ is non-negative: $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x} \geq 0$ for every vector $\tilde{x}$ of length p .

Example 0.59 (A positive semidefinite matrix). Let $\mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, which is symmetric. For any $\tilde{x} = (x_1, x_2)$:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{B} \tilde{x} &= x_1^2 + x_1 x_2 + x_2 x_1 + x_2^2 && \text{(multiply out the quadratic form)} \\ &= (x_1 + x_2)^2 && \text{(complete the square)} \\ &\geq 0 && \text{(a square is non-negative)} \end{aligned}$$

So $\mathbf{B}$ is positive semidefinite.

Definition 0.58 (Positive definite matrix). A $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ is **positive definite** if it satisfies both conditions:

- $\mathbf{A}$ is symmetric (Definition 0.41).
- Every quadratic form (Definition 0.49) in $\mathbf{A}$ at a nonzero vector is positive: $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x} > 0$ for every vector $\tilde{x} \neq \tilde{0}$ of length p .

Example 0.60 (Positive definite, semidefinite, and neither).

- The identity matrix $\mathbf{I}_p$ (Definition 0.40) is positive definite: $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{I}_p \tilde{x} = \sum_{i=1}^p x_i^2$, which is positive unless every x_i is 0.
- $\mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ from Example 0.59 is positive semidefinite but not positive definite: at $\tilde{x} = (1, -1) \neq \tilde{0}$, $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{B} \tilde{x} = (1 - 1)^2 = 0$.

- $\mathbf{D} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 \\ 2 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is symmetric but not positive semidefinite: at $\tilde{x} = (1, -1)$, $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{D} \tilde{x} = 1 - 2 - 2 + 1 = -2 < 0$.

Remark 0.32 (Why the definition requires symmetry). A positive definite matrix is positive semidefinite (Definition 0.57): $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x} > 0$ for every $\tilde{x} \neq \tilde{0}$, and $\tilde{0}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{0} = 0$. For example, $\mathbf{I}_p$ in Example 0.60 is both.

Some sources drop the symmetry condition from both definitions. These notes keep it, because without it a matrix can pass the quadratic-form condition and still have no real eigenvalues (Definition 0.54). For example, $\mathbf{C} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is not symmetric, and for any $\tilde{x} = (x_1, x_2)$:

$$\begin{aligned} \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{C} \tilde{x} &= x_1(x_1 + x_2) + x_2(-x_1 + x_2) && \text{(multiply out the quadratic form)} \\ &= x_1^2 + x_1x_2 - x_2x_1 + x_2^2 && \text{(distribute)} \\ &= x_1^2 + x_2^2 && \text{(the middle terms cancel)} \end{aligned}$$

which is positive for every $\tilde{x} \neq \tilde{0}$. But suppose $\mathbf{C}\tilde{v} = \lambda\tilde{v}$ for a real number λ . Matching entries gives $v_1 + v_2 = \lambda v_1$ and $-v_1 + v_2 = \lambda v_2$, so $v_2 = (\lambda - 1)v_1$ and $-v_1 = (\lambda - 1)v_2$. Substituting the first into the second gives $-v_1 = (\lambda - 1)^2 v_1$, so $(1 + (\lambda - 1)^2)v_1 = 0$. Since $1 + (\lambda - 1)^2 > 0$, $v_1 = 0$, and then $v_2 = (\lambda - 1)v_1 = 0$. So no real λ has an eigenvector $\tilde{v} \neq \tilde{0}$.

See also https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Definite_matrix.

Theorem 0.43 (Definiteness and eigenvalues). *Let $\mathbf{A}$ be a $p \times p$ symmetric matrix with real entries, with eigendecomposition $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{Q}^\top$ (Definition 0.55) and eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_p$ on the diagonal of $\mathbf{\Lambda}$. Then:*

- $\mathbf{A}$ is positive semidefinite (Definition 0.57) if and only if every $\lambda_i \geq 0$.
- $\mathbf{A}$ is positive definite (Definition 0.58) if and only if every $\lambda_i > 0$.

i Proof

Proof. For any vector $\tilde{x}$ of length p , let $\tilde{y} = \mathbf{Q}^\top \tilde{x}$. Then:

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x} &= \tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top \tilde{x} && \text{(substitute the eigendecomposition)} \\
&= (\mathbf{Q}^\top \tilde{x})^\top (\mathbf{Q}^\top \tilde{x}) && \text{(transpose of a product)} \\
&= \tilde{y}^\top \tilde{y} && \text{(definition of } \tilde{y}) \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^p \lambda_i y_i^2 && \text{(is diagonal)}
\end{aligned}$$

The second step is Theorem 0.10. Also, $\tilde{x} = \tilde{0}$ exactly when $\tilde{y} = \tilde{0}$: $\mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top = \mathbf{I}_p$ for an orthogonal matrix (Definition 0.48), so $\tilde{x} = \mathbf{Q} \tilde{y}$.

If every $\lambda_i \geq 0$, then every term $\lambda_i y_i^2 \geq 0$, so $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x} \geq 0$. If every $\lambda_i > 0$ and $\tilde{x} \neq \tilde{0}$, then some $y_i \neq 0$, so at least one term is positive and the rest are non-negative, and $\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{x} > 0$. Conversely, take $\tilde{x} = \tilde{q}_i$, column i of $\mathbf{Q}$, which is not $\tilde{0}$ because it has norm 1. Then $\tilde{y} = \mathbf{Q}^\top \tilde{q}_i$ is column i of $\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{I}_p$, so $y_i = 1$ and every other entry of $\tilde{y}$ is 0, and the display gives $\tilde{q}_i^\top \mathbf{A} \tilde{q}_i = \lambda_i$. So if $\mathbf{A}$ is positive semidefinite, $\lambda_i \geq 0$, and if $\mathbf{A}$ is positive definite, $\lambda_i > 0$. $\square$

Example 0.61 (Reading definiteness off the eigenvalues).

- $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$ has eigenvalues 3 and 1 (Example 0.54), both positive, so it is positive definite.
- $\mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ has eigenvalues 2, for the eigenvector $(1, 1)$, and 0, for the eigenvector $(1, -1)$, so it is positive semidefinite but not positive definite, as Example 0.60 found directly.

Theorem 0.44 (A positive definite matrix has a positive definite inverse). *Let $\mathbf{A}$ be a $p \times p$ positive definite matrix (Definition 0.58) with real entries, with eigendecomposition $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{Q} \mathbf{Q}^\top$ (Definition 0.55) and eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_p$. Then $\mathbf{A}$ is invertible (Definition 0.44),*

$$\mathbf{A}^{-1} = \mathbf{Q}^{-1} \mathbf{Q}^\top, \quad {}^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 1/\lambda_1 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & \cdots & 1/\lambda_p \end{bmatrix},$$

and $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ is positive definite.

Proof

Proof. By Theorem 0.43, every $\lambda_i > 0$, so ${}^{-1}$ is well defined, and multiplying the two diagonal matrices entry by entry gives ${}^{-1} = {}^{-1} = \mathbf{I}_p$. Write $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{Q}^{-1} \mathbf{Q}^\top$. Then:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{AB} &= \mathbf{QQ}^\top \mathbf{Q}^{-1} \mathbf{Q}^\top && \text{(substitute)} \\
&= \mathbf{Q} \mathbf{I}_p^{-1} \mathbf{Q}^\top && (\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q} = \mathbf{I}_p) \\
&= \mathbf{Q}^{-1} \mathbf{Q}^\top && \text{(identity matrix)} \\
&= \mathbf{QQ}^\top && (-1 = \mathbf{I}_p) \\
&= \mathbf{I}_p && (\mathbf{Q} \text{ is orthogonal})
\end{aligned}$$

The same steps, with $^{-1}$ and $^\top$ swapped, give $\mathbf{BA} = \mathbf{I}_p$, so $\mathbf{B} = \mathbf{A}^{-1}$ (Definition 0.43). The steps with $\mathbf{Q}$ use Definition 0.48, whose remark records that $\mathbf{QQ}^\top = \mathbf{I}_p$ too, and the identity step uses Theorem 0.31.

$\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ is symmetric by Corollary 0.2. For $\tilde{x} \neq \tilde{0}$, let $\tilde{y} = \mathbf{Q}^\top \tilde{x}$, which is not $\tilde{0}$ because $\tilde{x} = \mathbf{Q}\tilde{y}$. As in the proof of Theorem 0.43:

$$\begin{aligned}
\tilde{x}^\top \mathbf{A}^{-1} \tilde{x} &= \tilde{y}^\top {}^{-1} \tilde{y} && \text{(substitute } \mathbf{A}^{-1} = \mathbf{Q}^{-1} \mathbf{Q}^\top \text{)} \\
&= \sum_{i=1}^p \frac{y_i^2}{\lambda_i} && (-1 \text{ is diagonal)} \\
&> 0 && \text{(each } \lambda_i > 0, \text{ and some } y_i \neq 0 \text{)}
\end{aligned}$$

So $\mathbf{A}^{-1}$ is positive definite. □

Example 0.62 (Inverting a positive definite matrix). For $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$, Example 0.56

gives $\mathbf{Q} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix}$ and eigenvalues 3 and 1, so:

$$\begin{aligned}
\mathbf{A}^{-1} &= \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1/3 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(substitute; } \mathbf{Q} \text{ is symmetric)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 1/3 & 1 \\ 1/3 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply the first two matrices)} \\
&= \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} 4/3 & -2/3 \\ -2/3 & 4/3 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(multiply)} \\
&= \frac{1}{3} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} && \text{(simplify)}
\end{aligned}$$

Multiplying out, $\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \cdot \frac{1}{3} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} = \frac{1}{3} \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} = \mathbf{I}_2$.

Determinants

Definition 0.59 (Determinant). The **determinant** of a $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{A}$ with entries a_{ij} , written $\det(\mathbf{A})$ or $|\mathbf{A}|$, is the number defined recursively in p :

- For $p = 1$, $\det(\mathbf{A}) = a_{11}$.
- For $p \geq 2$,

$$\det(\mathbf{A}) = \sum_{j=1}^p (-1)^{1+j} a_{1j} \det(\mathbf{A}_{(1j)}),$$

where $\mathbf{A}_{(1j)}$ is the $(p-1) \times (p-1)$ matrix left after deleting row 1 and column j of $\mathbf{A}$.

Example 0.63 (Determinant of a 2×2 matrix). For $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$, deleting row 1 and column 1 leaves $[d]$, and deleting row 1 and column 2 leaves $[c]$. So:

$$\begin{aligned} \det(\mathbf{A}) &= (-1)^{1+1} a \det([d]) + (-1)^{1+2} b \det([c]) && \text{(definition, } p = 2) \\ &= ad - bc && \text{(definition, } p = 1) \end{aligned}$$

For example, $\det\left(\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}\right) = 2 \cdot 2 - 1 \cdot 1 = 3$.

Remark 0.33 (Cofactor expansion). The recursive formula in Definition 0.59 is the *cofactor expansion* along the first row. Other sources define the determinant as a sum over all orderings of the columns and derive this expansion from it; the two definitions agree (Banerjee and Roy 2014).

Each ordering picks one entry from each row, from the column that the ordering assigns to that row, and multiplies them. Its sign is $+1$ if the ordering takes an even number of swaps of two columns to reach from $(1, 2, \dots, p)$, and -1 if it takes an odd number.

For $p = 2$, the columns have two orderings. The ordering $(1, 2)$ keeps each column in place, picks the entries a_{11} and a_{22} , and has sign $+1$. The ordering $(2, 1)$ swaps the two columns, picks the entries a_{12} and a_{21} , and has sign -1 . The sum $a_{11}a_{22} - a_{12}a_{21}$ is the value $ad - bc$ from Example 0.63.

See also <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Determinant>.

Theorem 0.45 (Determinant of a diagonal matrix). *The determinant (Definition 0.59) of a $p \times p$ diagonal matrix (Definition 0.42) is the product of its diagonal entries:*

$$\det \left(\begin{bmatrix} d_1 & \cdots & 0 \\ \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ 0 & \cdots & d_p \end{bmatrix} \right) = \prod_{i=1}^p d_i$$

i Proof

Proof. By induction on p . For $p = 1$, the matrix is $[d_1]$, and its determinant is d_1 by definition.

For $p \geq 2$, suppose the result holds for $(p-1) \times (p-1)$ diagonal matrices, and let $\mathbf{D}$ be $p \times p$ and diagonal. Row 1 of $\mathbf{D}$ is $(d_1, 0, \dots, 0)$, so only the $j = 1$ term of the definition can be nonzero, and deleting row 1 and column 1 of $\mathbf{D}$ leaves the diagonal matrix with diagonal entries $d_2, \dots, d_p$:

$$\begin{aligned} \det(\mathbf{D}) &= (-1)^{1+1} d_1 \det(\mathbf{D}_{(11)}) + \sum_{j=2}^p (-1)^{1+j} \cdot 0 \cdot \det(\mathbf{D}_{(1j)}) && \text{(definition)} \\ &= d_1 \det(\mathbf{D}_{(11)}) && \text{(drop the zero terms)} \\ &= d_1 \prod_{i=2}^p d_i && \text{(induction hypothesis)} \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^p d_i && \text{(combine)} \end{aligned}$$

□

Example 0.64 (Determinant of a scaled identity matrix). For a number c , $c\mathbf{I}_p$ is diagonal with every diagonal entry equal to c , so $\det(c\mathbf{I}_p) = c^p$. In particular, $\det(\mathbf{I}_p) = 1$.

Theorem 0.46 (Determinant of a product). For $p \times p$ matrices $\mathbf{A}$ and $\mathbf{B}$,

$$\det(\mathbf{AB}) = \det(\mathbf{A}) \det(\mathbf{B}).$$

Example 0.65 (Checking the product rule). For $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$ and $\mathbf{B} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$, Example 0.63 gives $\det(\mathbf{A}) = 2 \cdot 1 - 1 \cdot 0 = 2$ and $\det(\mathbf{B}) = 1 \cdot 1 - 0 \cdot 3 = 1$. The product is

$$\mathbf{AB} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 3 & 2 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 \\ 0 \cdot 1 + 1 \cdot 3 & 0 \cdot 0 + 1 \cdot 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 5 & 1 \\ 3 & 1 \end{bmatrix},$$

with $\det(\mathbf{AB}) = 5 \cdot 1 - 1 \cdot 3 = 2 = \det(\mathbf{A}) \det(\mathbf{B})$.

Remark 0.34 (An example is not a proof). Example 0.65 checks Theorem 0.46 for one pair of 2×2 matrices, which shows the theorem holds there but does not prove it for every pair. The proof needs properties of the determinant that these notes don't develop; see Banerjee and Roy (2014).

See also <https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Determinant>.

Theorem 0.47 (The determinant of a symmetric matrix is the product of its eigenvalues). *Let $\mathbf{A}$ be a $p \times p$ symmetric matrix with real entries, with eigendecomposition $\mathbf{A} = \mathbf{Q}\mathbf{Q}^\top$ (Definition 0.55) and eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_p$ on the diagonal of $\mathbf{\Lambda}$. Then*

$$\det(\mathbf{A}) = \prod_{i=1}^p \lambda_i.$$

Proof

Proof. First, $\det(\mathbf{Q}^\top) \det(\mathbf{Q}) = 1$:

$$\begin{aligned} \det(\mathbf{Q}^\top) \det(\mathbf{Q}) &= \det(\mathbf{Q}^\top \mathbf{Q}) && \text{(determinant of a product)} \\ &= \det(\mathbf{I}_p) && \text{(\mathbf{Q} is orthogonal)} \\ &= 1 && \text{(determinant of the identity)} \end{aligned}$$

Then:

$$\begin{aligned} \det(\mathbf{A}) &= \det(\mathbf{Q}\mathbf{Q}^\top) && \text{(substitute the eigendecomposition)} \\ &= \det(\mathbf{Q}) \det(\mathbf{\Lambda}) \det(\mathbf{Q}^\top) && \text{(determinant of a product, twice)} \\ &= \det(\mathbf{\Lambda}) \cdot \det(\mathbf{Q}^\top) \det(\mathbf{Q}) && \text{(reorder the three numbers)} \\ &= \det(\mathbf{\Lambda}) && \text{(the first display)} \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^p \lambda_i && \text{(determinant of a diagonal matrix)} \end{aligned}$$

The product steps are Theorem 0.46, the orthogonality step is Definition 0.48, and the identity and diagonal steps are Theorem 0.45 and Example 0.64. $\square$

Corollary 0.3 (A positive definite matrix has a positive determinant). *If $\mathbf{A}$ is positive definite (Definition 0.58), then $\det(\mathbf{A}) > 0$.*

i Proof

Proof. By Theorem 0.43, every eigenvalue of $\mathbf{A}$ is positive, so their product, which is $\det(\mathbf{A})$ by Theorem 0.47, is positive. $\square$

Example 0.66 (Two ways to the same determinant). $\mathbf{A} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$ has eigenvalues 3 and 1 (Example 0.54), so Theorem 0.47 gives $\det(\mathbf{A}) = 3 \cdot 1 = 3$, matching $2 \cdot 2 - 1 \cdot 1 = 3$ from Example 0.63.

Design Matrix

Definition 0.60 (Design matrix). In a regression model with n observations and p predictors, the **design matrix** (or *model matrix*) $\mathbf{X}$ is the $n \times p$ matrix whose i -th row is the covariate vector $\tilde{x}_i^\top$ for observation i :

$$\mathbf{X} = \begin{bmatrix} \tilde{x}_1^\top \\ \tilde{x}_2^\top \\ \vdots \\ \tilde{x}_n^\top \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} x_{11} & x_{12} & \cdots & x_{1p} \\ x_{21} & x_{22} & \cdots & x_{2p} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ x_{n1} & x_{n2} & \cdots & x_{np} \end{bmatrix}$$

Remark 0.35 (Products with the design matrix). The product $\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta}$ collects the values $\tilde{x}_i^\top \tilde{\beta}$ for all n observations into a single $n \times 1$ vector:

$$\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} = \begin{bmatrix} \tilde{x}_1^\top \tilde{\beta} \\ \vdots \\ \tilde{x}_n^\top \tilde{\beta} \end{bmatrix}$$

For example, take the rank-2 matrix from Example 0.9 as $\mathbf{X}$, with $n = 3$ observations and $p = 2$ columns: an intercept column and one covariate. With $\tilde{\beta} = (1, 2)$,

$$\mathbf{X}\tilde{\beta} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 \\ 5 \\ 7 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The matrix $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ is $p \times p$ and symmetric, since $(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^\top = \mathbf{X}^\top (\mathbf{X}^\top)^\top = \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ (Theorem 0.10). When $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ is invertible, it appears in the OLS estimator $\hat{\tilde{\beta}} = (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top \tilde{y}$.

Theorem 0.48 ($\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ is invertible when $\mathbf{X}$ has full column rank). If $\mathbf{X}$ is an $n \times p$ matrix with $\text{rank}(\mathbf{X}) = p$ (Definition 0.26), then the $p \times p$ matrix $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ is invertible.

i Proof

Proof. Let $\tilde{c}$ be a vector of length p with $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} \tilde{c} = \tilde{0}$. Then

$$\begin{aligned} 0 &= \tilde{c}^\top \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} \tilde{c} && \text{(multiply } \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} \tilde{c} = \tilde{0} \text{ on the left by } \tilde{c}^\top) \\ &= (\mathbf{X} \tilde{c})^\top (\mathbf{X} \tilde{c}) && \text{(transpose of a product)} \\ &= \|\mathbf{X} \tilde{c}\|^2 && \text{(definition of the Euclidean norm)} \end{aligned}$$

so $\mathbf{X} \tilde{c} = \tilde{0}$. Because $\mathbf{X} \tilde{c} = c_1(\text{column 1}) + \dots + c_p(\text{column } p)$ and the columns of $\mathbf{X}$ are linearly independent, $\tilde{c} = \tilde{0}$. So the only solution of $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} \tilde{c} = \tilde{0}$ is $\tilde{c} = \tilde{0}$, which says that the columns of the square matrix $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ are linearly independent, and a square matrix with linearly independent columns is invertible (Banerjee and Roy 2014, Corollary 5.7, p. 143). $\square$

Example 0.67 (Inverting $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$). For the rank-2 matrix $\mathbf{X} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \\ 1 & 3 \end{bmatrix}$ from Example 0.9:

$$\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} = \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 6 \\ 6 & 14 \end{bmatrix}, \quad (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} = \frac{1}{6} \begin{bmatrix} 14 & -6 \\ -6 & 3 \end{bmatrix},$$

and multiplying the two out gives $\mathbf{I}_2$.

Definition 0.61 (Hat matrix). For an $n \times p$ design matrix $\mathbf{X}$ (Definition 0.60) with $\text{rank}(\mathbf{X}) = p$, the **hat matrix** is the $n \times n$ matrix

$$\mathbf{H} \stackrel{\text{def}}{=} \underbrace{\mathbf{X}}_{n \times p} \underbrace{(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1}}_{p \times p} \underbrace{\mathbf{X}^\top}_{p \times n}$$

The inverse exists by Theorem 0.48.

Example 0.68 (The hat matrix of an intercept-only model). With $n = 2$ observations and only an intercept, $\mathbf{X} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$ (2×1 , rank 1), so $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X} = 2$ and

$$\mathbf{H} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \cdot \frac{1}{2} \cdot \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & 0.5 \\ 0.5 & 0.5 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Then $\mathbf{H} \tilde{y} = (\bar{y}, \bar{y})$, where $\bar{y} = (y_1 + y_2)/2$: the fitted values of an intercept-only model are

the sample mean.

Theorem 0.49 (Hat matrix is a projection matrix). *If $\mathbf{X}$ is an $n \times p$ design matrix with $\text{rank}(\mathbf{X}) = p$, then the hat matrix $\mathbf{H}$ (Definition 0.61) is an orthogonal projection matrix (Definition 0.46).*

i Proof

Proof. We verify symmetry and idempotency. Both use that $\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ is symmetric, $(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^\top = \mathbf{X}^\top (\mathbf{X}^\top)^\top = \mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}$ (Theorem 0.10), so its inverse is symmetric too (Corollary 0.2).

Symmetry:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbf{H}^\top &= (\mathbf{X}(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top)^\top && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{H} \text{)} \\
 &= (\mathbf{X}^\top)^\top \cdot ((\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1})^\top \cdot \mathbf{X}^\top && \text{(transpose of a product, twice)} \\
 &= \mathbf{X} \cdot ((\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1})^\top \cdot \mathbf{X}^\top && \text{(transposing twice changes nothing)} \\
 &= \mathbf{X} \cdot (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \cdot \mathbf{X}^\top && \text{(the inverse of a symmetric matrix is symmetric)} \\
 &= \mathbf{H} && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{H} \text{)}
 \end{aligned}$$

Idempotency:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbf{H}^2 &= \mathbf{X}(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top \cdot \mathbf{X}(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{H} \text{)} \\
 &= \mathbf{X}(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X}) (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top && \text{(regroup; matrix multiplication is associative)} \\
 &= \mathbf{X} \mathbf{I}_p (\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top && \text{(definition of the inverse)} \\
 &= \mathbf{X}(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top && \text{(identity matrix)} \\
 &= \mathbf{H} && \text{(definition of } \mathbf{H} \text{)}
 \end{aligned}$$

□

Example 0.69 (The intercept-only hat matrix is a projection). For $\mathbf{H} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & 0.5 \\ 0.5 & 0.5 \end{bmatrix}$ from Example 0.68, $\mathbf{H}^\top = \mathbf{H}$, and

$$\mathbf{H}^2 = \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 \cdot 0.5 + 0.5 \cdot 0.5 & 0.5 \cdot 0.5 + 0.5 \cdot 0.5 \\ 0.5 \cdot 0.5 + 0.5 \cdot 0.5 & 0.5 \cdot 0.5 + 0.5 \cdot 0.5 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0.5 & 0.5 \\ 0.5 & 0.5 \end{bmatrix} = \mathbf{H},$$

as Theorem 0.49 says.

Remark 0.36 (Why it is called the hat matrix). The hat matrix gives the fitted values in linear regression: $\hat{\tilde{y}} = \mathbf{X}\hat{\tilde{\beta}} = \mathbf{X}(\mathbf{X}^\top \mathbf{X})^{-1} \mathbf{X}^\top \tilde{y} = \mathbf{H}\tilde{y}$. Multiplying by $\mathbf{H}$ “puts a hat” on $\tilde{y}$, which is where the name comes from. In Example 0.68, $\mathbf{H}$ puts a hat on $\tilde{y}$ by replacing each y_i with the sample mean $\bar{y}$.

Further reading

- Strang (2023) is a widely used first course in linear algebra. It covers vectors, elimination, vector spaces, orthogonality, determinants, eigenvalues, and the singular value decomposition.
- Axler (2024) is a proof-based treatment centered on vector spaces and linear maps. A free electronic version is available from the publisher.
- Fieller (2016)
- Banerjee and Roy (2014)
- Searle and Khuri (2017)

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